

A global spectral gap for Metropolis-adjusted Langevin algorithm with a uniformly randomized step size

Qian Qin
School of Statistics
University of Minnesota

Abstract

Let $\pi(dx) \propto e^{-U(x)} dx$ on $\mathbb{R}^d$, where $0 < m \leq L < \infty$, $mI_d \preceq \nabla^2 U(x) \preceq LI_d$, and $\kappa = L/m$. It is known that, under warm-start assumptions, fixed-step Metropolis-adjusted Langevin algorithm (MALA) with properly tuned step size has mixing time of order $\kappa\sqrt{d}$ up to logarithmic factors. By contrast, when the condition number is bounded away from one, no single fixed step size yields a matching spectral-gap lower bound of order $(\kappa\sqrt{d})^{-1}$ uniformly over this target class. We show that MALA with a uniformly randomized step size admits a spectral-gap lower bound of this size. At each iteration, the randomized-step MALA considered here draws h uniformly from $(0, H)$ and performs one ordinary MALA transition with step size h . We show that, when H is of order $(L\sqrt{d})^{-1}$, the right spectral gap of randomized-step MALA admits a lower bound of order

$$\frac{1}{\kappa\sqrt{d}[1 + \log(d+1) + \log \kappa]}.$$

The main new ingredient in the proof is a Cheeger-type inequality for aggregating estimates of the one-step flow of MALA out of measurable sets at various step-size scales. It allows the scale used to control the flow to depend on the set and avoids the additional loss that would result from first summing the flows and then applying the standard Cheeger inequality. This work was developed with substantial assistance from ChatGPT, which suggested the uniformly randomized-step approach, developed the principal proof arguments, and generated the simulation and Lean 4 code. The human author checked and verified the mathematical content and take full responsibility for the results.

1 Introduction

For a target probability distribution π on $\mathbb{R}^d$ with density proportional to e^{-U} , the Metropolis-adjusted Langevin algorithm (MALA) proposes

$$Y = x - h\nabla U(x) + \sqrt{2h}Z, \text{ where } Z \sim N_d(0, I_d),$$

and applies the Metropolis–Hastings correction. MALA is one of the most fundamental Markov chain Monte Carlo (MCMC) algorithms and has been studied extensively. Its classical geometric properties and high-dimensional scaling were developed by [Roberts and Tweedie \[1996\]](#), [Roberts and Rosenthal \[1998\]](#); it is also closely related to Hamiltonian Monte Carlo [[Neal, 2011](#), [Wu et al., 2022](#), [Chen and Gtarmir, 2023](#)].

For an m -strongly convex and L -smooth potential $U(\cdot)$, [Wu et al. \[2022\]](#), strengthening results in [Chewi et al. \[2021\]](#), show that the mixing time of (lazy) MALA from a warm start has the minimax $\kappa\sqrt{d}$ dependence, up to logarithmic factors, where $\kappa = L/m$ is the condition number. This rate

is achieved with a MALA step size h of order $(L\sqrt{d})^{-1}$ up to logarithmic factors. The proofs in Chewi et al. [2021] and Wu et al. [2022] control acceptance on a high-probability region and then use an s -conductance argument [Lovász and Simonovits, 1993]. They therefore do not lower-bound the ordinary conductance over sets of every positive stationary mass, and their arguments do not yield a matching global Poincaré bound of the form

$$\text{Gap}_R(P_h) \gtrsim \frac{1}{\kappa\sqrt{d}}, \quad (1)$$

where P_h is the Markov kernel of MALA with step size h , $\text{Gap}_R(\cdot)$ denotes the right spectral gap, and $\gtrsim$ suppresses universal constants and the logarithmic factors. (Recall that, for a lazy reversible Markov chain, the mixing time is roughly inversely proportional to the right spectral gap, so a gap of order $(\kappa\sqrt{d})^{-1}$ implies mixing time of order $\kappa\sqrt{d}$.) Under only strong convexity and gradient Lipschitzness, a fixed-step global Poincaré bound at the $d^{-1/2}$ scale is impossible uniformly over the target class. Indeed, following arguments from Chewi et al. [2021], Wu et al. [2022], we show that a bound of the form (1) cannot hold uniformly over all m -strongly convex and L -smooth potentials if $\kappa - 1$ is greater than a positive constant. In fact, in Proposition 2.3, it is shown that, when $\kappa \geq \kappa_0 > 1$ for some constant κ_0 , for any $h > 0$, there exists an m -strongly convex and L -smooth potential U such that $\text{Gap}_R(P_h)$ is upper bounded by a κ_0 -dependent multiple of the maximum of $\log(\kappa d)/(\kappa d)$ and e^{-cd} , where $c > 0$ is universal.

A global spectral-gap bound is useful for more than deriving a mixing-time estimate. Let P be a lazy, π -reversible Markov kernel. If μ is an initial distribution with $d\mu/d\pi \in L^2(\pi)$, then

$$\|\mu P^n - \pi\|_{\text{TV}} \leq \frac{1}{2} \left\| \frac{d\mu}{d\pi} - 1 \right\|_{L^2(\pi)} [1 - \text{Gap}_R(P)]^n.$$

Thus a spectral gap certifies convergence all the way to stationarity, rather than only for a prescribed accuracy [Kontoyiannis and Meyn, 2012, Roberts and Rosenthal, 1997, Rudolf, 2012]. More importantly for Monte Carlo, for a stationary reversible chain and a centered function in $L^2(\pi)$, a positive right spectral gap implies a central limit theorem for Markov-chain averages and controls their asymptotic variance [Kipnis and Varadhan, 1986]. Related spectral arguments also yield finite-sample variance, mean-square error, and concentration bounds for Markov-chain averages [Rudolf, 2012, Paulin, 2015]. By contrast, a favorable warm-start mixing bound can coexist with very high autocorrelation for certain $L^2(\pi)$ test functions.

Quantitative global spectral-gap results for MALA are considerably sparser than mixing-time bounds. The classical analysis of Roberts and Tweedie [1996] gives qualitative criteria for geometric ergodicity, rather than dimension-explicit lower bounds on the gap, while Bou-Rabee and Hairer [2013] show that, for drifts that are not globally Lipschitz, MALA may fail to have a spectral gap even when the underlying Langevin diffusion does. Wu et al. [2022] use spectral-gap upper bounds of order mh for specially constructed targets to establish their minimax mixing-time lower bound, but the existing fixed-step analyses do not provide a matching global spectral-gap lower bound when h is of order $(L\sqrt{d})^{-1}$. More recently, Liu and Tong [2026] establish $\text{Gap}_R(P_h) \gtrsim (\kappa^2 d)^{-1}$ when $h \lesssim (\kappa L d)^{-1}$. This spectral-gap bound gives a mixing-time bound of order $\kappa^2 d$, which is significantly worse than the $\kappa\sqrt{d}$ dependence achieved with a step size of order $(L\sqrt{d})^{-1}$.

We study the randomized kernel

$$\bar{P}_H = \frac{1}{H} \int_0^H P_h dh.$$

Operationally, the algorithm samples $h \sim \text{Unif}(0, H)$ and then performs one ordinary MALA step. It uses one proposal and has essentially the same computational cost as fixed-step MALA. By

linearity of detailed balance, it is exactly π -reversible. In [Theorem 2.1](#), we show that if U is twice continuously differentiable and H is of order $(L\sqrt{d})^{-1}$, then $\text{Gap}_R(\bar{P}_H)$ has a lower bound of order $(\kappa\sqrt{d})^{-1}$, up to logarithmic factors, matching the minimax mixing-time bound for fixed-step MALA.

Randomization of Metropolis tuning parameters has been advocated as a way to improve robustness. In the setting most directly relevant here, [Grazzi et al. \[2026\]](#) study the randomized kernel $\int P_h \nu(dh)$, where ν is a distribution on $(0, \infty)$. They show that randomized kernels inherit spectral gaps and weak Poincaré inequalities from suitable fixed-step components and that randomization can turn severe sensitivity to step-size misspecification into a much milder deterioration of the spectral gap. The intuition is that a randomized method may sacrifice some peak asymptotic efficiency in exchange for performing reasonably over a much wider range of scales. Related benefits of randomization are known for Hamiltonian methods [[Bou-Rabee and Sanz-Serna, 2017](#), [Apers et al., 2024](#)].

As shown in [Grazzi et al. \[2026\]](#), the randomized kernel satisfies the inheritance bound $\text{Gap}_R(\bar{P}_H) \geq H^{-1} \int_0^H \text{Gap}_R(P_h) dh$. This inequality alone, however, does not yield the $(\kappa\sqrt{d})^{-1}$ rate sought here, because no available fixed-step result establishes $\text{Gap}_R(P_h) \gtrsim (\kappa\sqrt{d})^{-1}$, regardless of h . To be more specific, existing conductance lower bounds, which are translated into spectral-gap lower bounds via Cheeger’s inequality [[Lawler and Sokal, 1988](#)], are considerably smaller than desired at every scale. Recall that Cheeger’s inequality asserts that $\text{Gap}_R(P_h)$ is lower bounded by $\phi(P_h)^2/2$, where $\phi(P_h)$ is the global conductance:

$$\phi(P_h) := \inf_{S: 0 < \pi(S) \leq 1/2} \frac{\mathcal{J}_{P_h}(S, S^c)}{\pi(S)}, \quad \mathcal{J}_{P_h}(S, S^c) = \int_S P_h(x, S^c) \pi(dx).$$

To apply Cheeger’s inequality, we want a lower bound on $\phi(P_h)$ that is of order $(\kappa\sqrt{d})^{-1/2}$ for a sufficiently large set of $h \in [0, H]$. More precisely, [Liu and Tong \[2026\]](#) obtain a lower bound on $\phi(P_h)$ of order $(\kappa^2 d)^{-1/2}$ for $h \lesssim (\kappa L d)^{-1}$. For h of order $(L\sqrt{d})^{-1}$, [Wu et al. \[2022\]](#) obtain a lower bound of order $(\kappa\sqrt{d})^{-1/2}$ on $\mathcal{J}_{P_h}(S, S^c)/\pi(S)$ when $\pi(S)$ exceeds a certain threshold; below that threshold, however, the ratio can scale very poorly with d .

Our argument exploits information that the preceding inheritance bound discards: the step-size range used to control the flow out of a set may depend on the stationary mass of that set. For each measurable $S \subset \mathbb{R}^d$, we select a range of step sizes tailored to $\pi(S)$, using progressively smaller steps as $\pi(S)$ decreases. When $\pi(S)$ is not too small, comparatively larger steps can be used: the Metropolis acceptance rate is lower bounded by a positive constant over S , outside an exceptional set with small stationary mass [[Chewi et al., 2021](#), [Wu et al., 2022](#)]. Writing $\mathcal{K}_t = (2/t) \int_{t/2}^t P_h dh$ for the kernel averaged over the upper dyadic half of $(0, t)$, one can then lower-bound the one-step flow $\mathcal{J}_{\mathcal{K}_t}(S, S^c)$ by a suitable multiple of $\pi(S)$. For smaller sets, the exceptional region in the preceding argument can no longer be ignored, and we instead use a smaller, globally safe step size which leads to a constant uniform lower bound on the acceptance rate over the whole space. Gaussian isoperimetry then supplies the corresponding lower bound on the flow out of S .

Finally, we combine the flow estimates obtained at the different scales using a Cheeger-type aggregation lemma ([Lemma 3.5](#)) for mixtures of reversible Markov kernels. The lemma lets us use relatively large steps for sets of moderate stationary mass and smaller steps for rarer sets, without losing an additional factor equal to the probability of selecting the useful step-size range. The closest analytic predecessor is the general Cheeger inequality of [Chen and Wang \[2000\]](#), which can be used to derive [Lemma 3.5](#). We give a direct proof and a more transparent formulation ([Theorem 3.6](#)) suitable for the present setting.

An accompanying Lean 4 development formally verifies the main theorem and the other principal theorem-level conclusions from their stated assumptions. This includes the [Theorem 2.1](#), [Proposition 2.3](#), [Lemma 3.5](#), and [Theorem 3.6](#). The scope of the verification is described in [Section 5](#).

Relation to existing work

Controlling the rejection rate is central to the analysis of MALA. There are several approaches to controlling MALA rejection at the $d^{-1/2}$ scale. [Chewi et al. \[2021\]](#) use a projection characterization of Metropolis adjustment and compare the Euler proposal with exact Langevin diffusion. [Wu et al. \[2022\]](#) instead compare one leapfrog step with continuous Hamiltonian dynamics. Earlier pathwise comparisons between Metropolized integrators and their limiting diffusions include [Bou-Rabee and Vanden-Eijnden \[2010\]](#), [Bou-Rabee and Hairer \[2013\]](#).

Our appendix follows the diffusion-comparison philosophy. The stationary increment estimate follows from the Lyons–Zheng forward–backward decomposition [[Lyons and Zheng, 1988](#), Section 1, especially equation (1.7)]; see also [Fukushima et al. \[2011, Theorem 5.7.1\]](#). We give an elementary proof for Langevin diffusion by writing the stochastic differential equation along the forward and reversed paths and subtracting the resulting expressions to cancel the drift. A Girsanov change of path law then compares the exact diffusion with the drift frozen at its initial state. Endpoint conditioning and the Metropolis–Hastings meet identity [[Tierney, 1998](#), [Billera and Diaconis, 2001](#)] convert the path estimate into an $L^p(\pi)$ rejection bound.

The close-coupling and isoperimetric part of the argument is standard in modern Metropolis analyses [[Dwivedi et al., 2019](#), [Wu et al., 2022](#), [Andrieu et al., 2024](#), [Liu and Tong, 2026](#)]. The use of a scale indexed by set size is related in spirit to average conductance, evolving sets, blocking conductance, and spectral profiles [[Lovász and Kannan, 1999](#), [Morris and Peres, 2005](#), [Goel et al., 2006](#), [Kannan et al., 2006](#)].

The closest analytic predecessor of our aggregation lemma is [Chen and Wang \[2000\]](#). They prove a general version of Cheeger’s inequality that applies in settings considerably broader than the Markov-kernel setting considered here and extends the earlier results of [Lawler and Sokal \[1988\]](#). Their result can be used to derive our aggregation lemma, although the proof we give is direct and self-contained. The part specific to our argument is the way the lemma is combined with the set-dependent choice of scale: different sets may require different step-size ranges. We use this idea to combine flow estimates over a geometric sequence of step-size ranges for randomized-step MALA.

Generative AI disclosure

This project began when the author asked ChatGPT (OpenAI) whether MALA admits a useful global spectral-gap bound at the $d^{-1/2}$ step-size scale. ChatGPT suggested studying a uniformly randomized-step version of MALA—an algorithmic variant that had previously appeared in the literature—and developed the principal proof strategy and initial versions of the major mathematical arguments in this article. It also assisted in drafting and revising the manuscript and generated all code used for the numerical experiments and the Lean 4 formal verification. The human author checked the relevant literature, scrutinized and revised the AI-generated arguments, verified the mathematical claims and computations, inspected the simulation methodology and results, and confirmed that the Lean development was kernel-checked without proof placeholders or problem-specific axioms. The human author takes full responsibility for the content and correctness of the article.

2 Setup and Main Result

Assume throughout that d is a positive integer and that $U : \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is twice continuously differentiable with

$$mI_d \preceq \nabla^2 U(x) \preceq LI_d, \quad x \in \mathbb{R}^d,$$

where $0 < m \leq L < \infty$. Let $\kappa := L/m \geq 1$, and define the target distribution

$$\pi(\mathrm{d}x) = \frac{e^{-U(x)}}{\int_{\mathbb{R}^d} e^{-U(u)} \mathrm{d}u} \mathrm{d}x.$$

For $h > 0$, let $Q_h(x, \cdot)$ be the Gaussian law

$$N_d(x - h\nabla U(x), 2hI_d).$$

The fixed-step MALA kernel is

$$P_h(x, \mathrm{d}y) = \alpha_h(x, y) Q_h(x, \mathrm{d}y) + \left[1 - \int \alpha_h(x, z) Q_h(x, \mathrm{d}z)\right] \delta_x(\mathrm{d}y),$$

where

$$\alpha_h(x, y) = 1 \wedge \frac{e^{-U(y)} q_h(y, x)}{e^{-U(x)} q_h(x, y)}$$

and q_h is the density of Q_h . The usual Metropolis–Hastings argument makes P_h π -reversible [Tierney, 1998]; consequently, so is the randomized-step MALA kernel $\bar{P}_H = H^{-1} \int_0^H P_h \mathrm{d}h$.

For probability measures μ, ν on a measurable space $(\Omega, \mathcal{F})$, write

$$\mathrm{TV}(\mu, \nu) = \sup_{A \in \mathcal{F}} |\mu(A) - \nu(A)|.$$

For a probability measure ϖ , let $L^2(\varpi)$ be the space of measurable functions $f : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that $\int f^2 \mathrm{d}\varpi < \infty$. For a ϖ -reversible kernel P and $f \in L^2(\varpi)$, define the Dirichlet form

$$\mathcal{E}_P(f, f) = \frac{1}{2} \int [f(x) - f(y)]^2 \varpi(\mathrm{d}x) P(x, \mathrm{d}y).$$

The right, or Poincaré, spectral gap is defined as

$$\mathrm{Gap}_R(P) = \inf_{\substack{f \in L^2(\varpi) \\ \mathrm{Var}_\varpi(f) > 0}} \frac{\mathcal{E}_P(f, f)}{\mathrm{Var}_\varpi(f)}.$$

This quantity controls the convergence properties of the Markov chain associated with P if P is lazy or positive semidefinite.

The main result of this paper is stated below. Its proof is given in [Sections 3 and 4](#).

Theorem 2.1. *There are universal constants $A_0 \in [2, \infty)$, $b_0 \in (0, 1/2]$, and $c_0 \in (0, \infty)$ such that the following holds. Define*

$$p_\star = A_0 \{1 + \log(d+1) + \log \kappa\}.$$

Then, for every $H > 0$,

$$\mathrm{Gap}_R(\bar{P}_H) \geq c_0 \frac{m}{H} \min \left\{ H, \frac{b_0}{L} \max \left\{ \frac{1}{\sqrt{p_\star(d+p_\star)}}, \frac{1}{d} \right\} \right\}^2. \quad (2)$$

For the lazy kernel $(I + \bar{P}_H)/2$, the right-hand side is divided by two.

Corollary 2.2. *Under the assumptions of Theorem 2.1, let $H = c/(L\sqrt{d})$ for some $c > 0$. Then*

$$\text{Gap}_R(\bar{P}_H) \geq \frac{c_0}{\kappa\sqrt{d}} \min \left\{ c, \frac{b_0^2}{c} \max \left\{ \frac{d}{p_*(d+p_*)}, \frac{1}{d} \right\} \right\}.$$

In particular, since $\min\{p_(d+p_*)/d, d\} \leq 2p_*$,*

$$\text{Gap}_R(\bar{P}_H) \geq \frac{c_0}{\kappa\sqrt{d}} \min \left\{ c, \frac{b_0^2}{2cp_*} \right\}.$$

The spectral gap lower bound of order $(\kappa\sqrt{d})^{-1}$ for randomized-step MALA is in sharp contrast with the following upper bound on the spectral gap of fixed-step MALA, which is proved in [Section A](#).

Proposition 2.3. *Fix $\kappa_0 > 1$. There are a universal constant $c > 0$ and a constant $C > 0$ depending only on κ_0 such that the following holds. Let $d \geq 2$, $0 < m < L$, and $\kappa = L/m \geq \kappa_0$. Then*

$$\sup_{h>0} \inf_{\substack{U \in C^\infty(\mathbb{R}^d) \\ mI_d \leq \nabla^2 U(x) \leq LI_d, \ x \in \mathbb{R}^d}} \text{Gap}_R(P_{U,h}) \leq C \max \left\{ \frac{\log(\kappa d)}{\kappa d}, e^{-cd} \right\}. \quad (3)$$

Here $P_{U,h}$ denotes the MALA kernel with step size h and target density proportional to e^{-U} .

The proof of [Proposition 2.3](#) utilizes constructions from [Chewi et al. \[2021\]](#) and [Wu et al. \[2022\]](#). Both of these works construct a hard target distribution and use it to bound the spectral gap of fixed-step MALA from above. Their results do not readily yield the upper bound herein. We use a modified version of the construction in [Wu et al. \[2022\]](#) to obtain the bound.

3 Ingredients of the Proof

We now describe the main ingredients of the proof of [Theorem 2.1](#).

For $t > 0$, define the MALA kernel averaged over the upper dyadic half of $(0, t)$ by

$$\mathcal{K}_t = \frac{2}{t} \int_{t/2}^t P_h \, dh.$$

The uniform mixture $\bar{P}_H$ contains this component with weight $t/(2H)$ whenever $t \leq H$. The following elementary relation holds.

Lemma 3.1. *Let $0 < t_J < \dots < t_0 \leq H$, and suppose that the intervals $(t_j/2, t_j)$, $j \in \{0, \dots, J\}$, are pairwise disjoint. Then, for $f \in L^2(\pi)$,*

$$\mathcal{E}_{\bar{P}_H}(f, f) \geq \sum_{j=0}^J \frac{t_j}{2H} \mathcal{E}_{\mathcal{K}_{t_j}}(f, f).$$

Proof. By nonnegativity and Tonelli's theorem,

$$\mathcal{E}_{\bar{P}_H}(f, f) = \frac{1}{H} \int_0^H \mathcal{E}_{P_h}(f, f) \, dh \geq \sum_{j=0}^J \frac{1}{H} \int_{t_j/2}^{t_j} \mathcal{E}_{P_h}(f, f) \, dh.$$

The definition of $\mathcal{K}_{t_j}$ gives the claim. □

We will analyze $\mathcal{K}_t$ at different scale parameters t , and aggregate results along an appropriate sequence of scale levels in a way that is more sophisticated than [Lemma 3.1](#).

To be more specific, in [Proposition B.1](#), we bound the fixed-step MALA rejection rate and use this bound to establish a close-coupling, or one-step overlap, result for $\mathcal{K}_t$ in [Proposition 3.2](#). The curvature assumption on U yields the isoperimetric inequality in [Proposition 3.3](#). We then combine [Propositions 3.2](#) and [3.3](#) in [Proposition 3.4](#) to bound the one-step flow for $\mathcal{K}_t$ out of a given set S . Importantly, for each set S , the flow out of S is controlled for one particular $\mathcal{K}_t$ where the scale parameter t depends on S . The general component-aggregation bound in [Theorem 3.6](#) combines the one-step flows at various scales, yielding [Theorem 2.1](#).

3.1 Close coupling

The next proposition, proved in [Section B](#), shows that $\mathcal{K}_t(x, \cdot)$ and $\mathcal{K}_t(y, \cdot)$ are close in total variation whenever $\|x - y\| \leq \sqrt{t}/16$. For the larger admissible values of t , this conclusion is guaranteed only when x and y lie outside a small exceptional set.

Proposition 3.2. *There are universal constants $c_r, C_r > 0$ such that, for every real $p \geq 2$ and every t satisfying*

$$0 < t \leq \frac{c_r}{L\sqrt{p(d+p)}}, \quad (4)$$

there is a measurable set $G_{t,p} \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$ satisfying

$$\pi(G_{t,p}^c) \leq \left[C_r L t \sqrt{p(d+p)} \right]^p, \quad (5)$$

and

$$x, y \in G_{t,p}, \quad \|x - y\| \leq \frac{\sqrt{t}}{16} \implies \text{TV}(\mathcal{K}_t(x, \cdot), \mathcal{K}_t(y, \cdot)) \leq \frac{3}{4}.$$

Moreover, if $t' \in (0, 1/(2Ld)]$, then

$$x, y \in \mathbb{R}^d, \quad \|x - y\| \leq \frac{\sqrt{t'}}{16} \implies \text{TV}(\mathcal{K}_{t'}(x, \cdot), \mathcal{K}_{t'}(y, \cdot)) \leq \frac{3}{4}.$$

3.2 Isoperimetric inequality

It is well known that a strongly log-concave distribution satisfies a Gaussian isoperimetric inequality. Corollary 2.2 and equations (2.10)–(2.12) of [Bakry and Ledoux \[1996, pp. 267–268\]](#) imply

$$\pi(A^r) \geq \Phi(\Phi^{-1}(\pi(A)) + \sqrt{m}r), \quad (6)$$

where, for $r > 0$, $A^r = \{x : \text{dist}(x, A) < r\}$, and Φ is the standard Gaussian distribution function. The following three-set form of the isoperimetric inequality is proved in [Section C](#).

Proposition 3.3. *Let A, B, C be a measurable partition of $\mathbb{R}^d$, let $r \geq 0$, and suppose $\text{dist}(A, B) \geq r$. If $0 < q = \min\{\pi(A), \pi(B)\} \leq 1/2$, then*

$$\pi(C) \geq \frac{q}{4} \min \left\{ 1, r \sqrt{m \log(1/q)} \right\}. \quad (7)$$

3.3 One-step flow

For a π -reversible Markov kernel K , define the one-step flow

$$\mathcal{J}_K(S, S^c) = \int_S K(x, S^c) \pi(dx).$$

Combining [Proposition 3.2](#) and [Proposition 3.3](#), we establish the following result concerning $\mathcal{K}_t$ in [Section D](#).

Proposition 3.4. *One can find universal constants $b_0 \in (0, 1/2]$ and $A_0 \in [2, \infty)$ such that the following holds. Let $p \geq p_\star := A_0\{1 + \log(d+1) + \log \kappa\}$, $\theta \in (0, 1]$, and*

$$t = \frac{\theta b_0}{L \sqrt{p(d+p)}}.$$

Then, for every measurable set $S \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$ such that $e^{-p/2} \leq \pi(S) \leq 1/2$,

$$\mathcal{J}_{\mathcal{K}_t}(S, S^c) \geq 2^{-13} \pi(S) \sqrt{mt \log(1/\pi(S))},$$

where $mt \log(1/\pi(S)) \leq 1$.

Moreover, for $t' \in (0, 1/(2Ld)]$ and every measurable set $S \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$ such that $0 < \pi(S) \leq 1/2$,

$$\mathcal{J}_{\mathcal{K}_{t'}}(S, S^c) \geq 2^{-13} \pi(S) \min \left\{ 1, \sqrt{mt' \log(1/\pi(S))} \right\}.$$

3.4 Aggregation of one-step flows

Cheeger's inequality [[Lawler and Sokal, 1988](#)] implies that the spectral gap of a reversible Markov kernel can be estimated by considering the kernel's one-step flow out of measurable sets. It turns out that a direct estimate of the total flow followed by the usual Cheeger inequality loses too much and does not yield the spectral lower bound of order $(\kappa\sqrt{d})^{-1}$ that we desire. We carry out the more careful approach below.

In [Section 4](#), we partition $[0, H]$ into disjoint intervals of the form $[t_j/2, t_j]$, where $(t_0, \dots, t_J)$ is a decreasing sequence of positive numbers. For a given measurable set S , the flow $\mathcal{J}_{\mathcal{K}_{t_j}}(S, S^c)$ may be large for some values of j but small for others. We therefore assign to each set S an appropriate index $j(S)$ and establish a lower bound on $\mathcal{J}_{\mathcal{K}_{t_{j(S)}}}(S, S^c)$. The purpose of this subsection is to provide the tools for combining these set-dependent bounds into a lower bound on $\text{Gap}_R(\bar{P}_H)$.

The following lemma carries out this aggregation for a generic mixture of reversible Markov kernels. Roughly speaking, it allows the kernel that supplies the useful one-step flow bound to depend on the set under consideration, while keeping track of how often each kernel is selected in the mixture. The lemma can also be derived from the general Cheeger inequality of [Chen and Wang \[2000\]](#). We give a direct proof in [Section E](#).

Lemma 3.5. *Let $P, K_1, \dots, K_N$ be Markov kernels that are reversible with respect to a distribution ϖ . Suppose that there exist constants $\gamma_1, \dots, \gamma_N > 0$ such that*

$$\mathcal{E}_P(f, f) \geq \sum_{j=1}^N \gamma_j \mathcal{E}_{K_j}(f, f) \quad \text{for every } f \in L^2(\varpi).$$

Suppose further that there exist constants $\beta_1, \dots, \beta_N \geq 0$ satisfying

$$\sum_{j=1}^N \frac{\beta_j^2}{\gamma_j} > 0$$

such that, for every measurable set S satisfying $0 < \varpi(S) \leq 1/2$,

$$\sum_{j=1}^N \beta_j \mathcal{J}_{K_j}(S, S^c) \geq \varpi(S),$$

where

$$\mathcal{J}_{K_j}(S, S^c) = \int_S K_j(x, S^c) \varpi(dx).$$

Then

$$\text{Gap}_R(P) \geq \left(2 \sum_{j=1}^N \frac{\beta_j^2}{\gamma_j} \right)^{-1}.$$

The fractional lemma gives the following convenient harmonic-sum formulation, which we use to combine the flow bounds in [Proposition 3.4](#).

Theorem 3.6. *Let $P, K_1, \dots, K_N$ be Markov kernels that are reversible with respect to a distribution ϖ . Suppose*

$$\mathcal{E}_P(f, f) \geq \sum_{j=1}^N \gamma_j \mathcal{E}_{K_j}(f, f), \quad \gamma_j > 0,$$

for every $f \in L^2(\varpi)$.

Suppose further that there exist constants $\phi_1, \dots, \phi_N > 0$ such that every measurable set S with $0 < \varpi(S) \leq 1/2$ can be assigned an index $j(S) \in \{1, \dots, N\}$ satisfying

$$\mathcal{J}_{K_{j(S)}}(S, S^c) \geq \phi_{j(S)} \varpi(S).$$

Then

$$\text{Gap}_R(P) \geq \left(2 \sum_{j=1}^N \frac{1}{\gamma_j \phi_j^2} \right)^{-1}.$$

Proof. Apply [Lemma 3.5](#) with

$$\beta_j = \frac{1}{\phi_j}, \quad j = 1, \dots, N.$$

For every measurable S with $0 < \varpi(S) \leq 1/2$,

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{j=1}^N \beta_j \mathcal{J}_{K_j}(S, S^c) &\geq \frac{\mathcal{J}_{K_{j(S)}}(S, S^c)}{\phi_{j(S)}} \\ &\geq \varpi(S). \end{aligned}$$

The conclusion follows directly from [Lemma 3.5](#). □

4 Proof of the Main Theorem

Proof of Theorem 2.1. Let $b_0 \leq 1/2$ and $A_0 \geq 2$ be given in [Proposition 3.4](#), and recall that $p_\star = A_0\{1 + \log(d+1) + \log \kappa\}$. We divide the proof into three parts.

Part 1: The geometric moment ladder.

Suppose for now that $p_\star < d$. Let

$$p_j = 4^j p_\star, \quad j = 0, 1, \dots, J, \quad (8)$$

where J is the smallest integer for which $p_J \geq d$. Thus

$$d \leq p_J < 4d. \quad (9)$$

Define the nominal endpoints

$$\tau_j = \frac{b_0}{L\sqrt{p_j(d + p_j)}},$$

and put

$$\theta = \min \left\{ 1, \frac{H}{\tau_0} \right\}, \quad t_j = \theta \tau_j. \quad (10)$$

Then $t_0 \leq H$, and

$$\frac{t_{j+1}}{t_j} = \frac{1}{2} \sqrt{\frac{d + p_j}{d + 4p_j}} < \frac{1}{2}.$$

Consequently, the Borel sets $[t_j/2, t_j]$ are pairwise disjoint, have Lebesgue measure $t_j/2$, and lie within $[0, H]$. Applying [Lemma 3.1](#) to this finite family gives

$$\mathcal{E}_{\overline{P}_H}(f, f) \geq \sum_{j=0}^J \frac{t_j}{2H} \mathcal{E}_{\mathcal{K}_{t_j}}(f, f). \quad (11)$$

This allows us to apply [Theorem 3.6](#).

Let S be measurable with $0 < \pi(S) \leq 1/2$. We assign S to a component $\mathcal{K}_{t_j}$. Since $p_0 = p_\star \geq A_0 \geq 2$, one has $p_0/2 \geq 1 > \log 2$. The intervals $[\log 2, p_0/2]$, $(p_{j-1}/2, p_j/2]$ for $1 \leq j \leq J$, and $(p_J/2, \infty)$ are disjoint and cover $[\log 2, \infty)$. Thus the following assignment is exhaustive and unambiguous.

- If $\log 2 \leq \log(1/\pi(S)) \leq p_0/2$, assign S to $\mathcal{K}_{t_0}$. By the first assertion of [Proposition 3.4](#),

$$\mathcal{J}_{\mathcal{K}_{t_0}}(S, S^c) \geq \phi_0 \pi(S), \quad \phi_0 = 2^{-13} \sqrt{mt_0 \log 2}.$$

- For $1 \leq j \leq J$, if $p_{j-1}/2 < \log(1/\pi(S)) \leq p_j/2$, assign S to $\mathcal{K}_{t_j}$. By the first assertion of [Proposition 3.4](#),

$$\mathcal{J}_{\mathcal{K}_{t_j}}(S, S^c) \geq \phi_j \pi(S), \quad \phi_j = 2^{-13} \sqrt{\frac{mt_j p_{j-1}}{2}} = 2^{-13} \sqrt{\frac{mt_j p_j}{8}}.$$

- If $\log(1/\pi(S)) > p_J/2$, assign S to the last component $\mathcal{K}_{t_J}$. By (9) and the assumption $b_0 \leq 1/2$,

$$t_J \leq \frac{b_0}{L\sqrt{p_J(d + p_J)}} \leq \frac{1}{2Ld}.$$

By the second assertion of [Proposition 3.4](#),

$$\mathcal{J}_{\mathcal{K}_{t_J}}(S, S^c) \geq \phi'_J \pi(S), \quad \phi'_J = 2^{-13} \min \left\{ 1, \sqrt{\frac{mt_J p_J}{2}} \right\}.$$

Moreover,

$$\frac{mt_J p_J}{2} \leq \frac{b_0}{2\kappa} \sqrt{\frac{p_J}{d+p_J}} \leq \frac{b_0}{2} < 1.$$

Weakening this bound by a constant factor, we obtain

$$\mathcal{J}_{\mathcal{K}_{t_J}}(S, S^c) \geq \phi_J \pi(S), \quad \phi_J = 2^{-13} \sqrt{\frac{mt_J p_J}{8}}.$$

We may therefore apply [Theorem 3.6](#) to (11), with

$$\gamma_j = \frac{t_j}{2H}, \quad \phi_0^2 = 2^{-26} m t_0 \log 2, \quad \phi_j^2 = 2^{-29} m t_j p_j \quad (j \geq 1).$$

The summation estimate in [Lemma F.1](#) yields

$$\sum_{j=0}^J \frac{1}{\gamma_j \phi_j^2} \leq C \frac{H L^2 p_*(d+p_*)}{m \theta^2 b_0^2},$$

where C is universal. Hence,

$$\text{Gap}_R(\bar{P}_H) \geq \frac{m \theta^2 b_0^2}{2CHL^2 p_*(d+p_*)} = \frac{m}{2CH} \min \left\{ H, \frac{b_0}{L \sqrt{p_*(d+p_*)}} \right\}^2. \quad (12)$$

Part 2: A conservative bound

The bound (12) is almost what we need, but it has been established only for $p_* < d$. To obtain the exact bound in [Theorem 2.1](#), we derive a lower bound on $\text{Gap}_R(\bar{P}_H)$ using only conservative step sizes.

Define the safe step size

$$t_s = \min \left\{ H, \frac{b_0}{Ld} \right\}.$$

Because $b_0 \leq 1/2$, $t_s \leq 1/(2Ld)$. For every measurable S with $0 < \pi(S) \leq 1/2$, apply the second assertion of [Proposition 3.4](#) to obtain

$$\mathcal{J}_{\mathcal{K}_{t_s}}(S, S^c) \geq 2^{-13} \pi(S) \min \left\{ 1, \sqrt{m t_s \log(1/\pi(S))} \right\} \geq 2^{-13} \pi(S) \min \left\{ 1, \sqrt{m t_s \log 2} \right\}. \quad (13)$$

Since

$$m t_s \log 2 \leq \frac{b_0 \log 2}{\kappa d} < 1,$$

the bound (13) becomes

$$\mathcal{J}_{\mathcal{K}_{t_s}}(S, S^c) \geq 2^{-13} \pi(S) \sqrt{m t_s \log 2}.$$

By [Lemma 3.1](#),

$$\mathcal{E}_{\bar{P}_H}(f, f) \geq \frac{t_s}{2H} \mathcal{E}_{\mathcal{K}_{t_s}}(f, f).$$

Apply [Theorem 3.6](#) with $N = 1$, $K_1 = \mathcal{K}_{t_s}$, $\gamma_1 = t_s/(2H)$, and $\phi_1 = 2^{-13} \sqrt{m t_s \log 2}$ to obtain

$$\text{Gap}_R(\bar{P}_H) \geq 2^{-28} (\log 2) \frac{m t_s^2}{H} = 2^{-28} (\log 2) \frac{m}{H} \min \left\{ H, \frac{b_0}{Ld} \right\}^2. \quad (14)$$

Part 3: Completion of the proof

If $p_\star \geq d$, then

$$\frac{1}{\sqrt{p_\star(d + p_\star)}} \leq \frac{1}{d},$$

so the safe bound (14) already gives (2). If $p_\star < d$, combine (12) and (14). For positive a, b, H ,

$$\max\{\min(H, a)^2, \min(H, b)^2\} = \min\{H, \max(a, b)\}^2.$$

Then (2) follows.

It remains to verify the assertion about lazification. Since the identity kernel has zero Dirichlet form,

$$\mathcal{E}_{(I + \bar{P}_H)/2}(f, f) = \frac{1}{2} \mathcal{E}_{\bar{P}_H}(f, f),$$

so

$$\text{Gap}_R((I + \bar{P}_H)/2) = \frac{1}{2} \text{Gap}_R(\bar{P}_H).$$

□

5 Lean verification

An accompanying Lean 4 development formalizes the principal results of this article. It proves both the non-lazy and half-lazy conclusions of [Theorem 2.1](#), with the same universal constants in the two conclusions, as well as both spectral-gap bounds in [Corollary 2.2](#). On the fixed-step side, it verifies the explicit hard-target bound in [Proposition A.1](#) and the resulting minimax upper bound in [Proposition 2.3](#). Thus, the formalization covers both the positive result for randomized-step MALA and the contrasting obstruction for fixed-step MALA.

The main ingredients of the randomized-step argument are also formalized. These include the comparison between the Dirichlet form of the uniform mixture and those of its disjoint dyadic components in [Lemma 3.1](#); the close coupling bound in [Proposition 3.2](#); the Gaussian isoperimetric separation bound in [Proposition 3.3](#); and both one-step flow estimates in [Proposition 3.4](#). The formalization further verifies the Cheeger-type aggregation lemma [Lemma 3.5](#) and its hard-assignment specialization [Theorem 3.6](#). In particular, these two results are proved with the L^2 energy-domination assumption stated in the manuscript. The auxiliary Gaussian-shift, defective-flow, exceptional-set, and multiscale summation estimates in [Lemmas C.2, D.1, D.2](#) and [F.1](#) are formalized as well.

The stationary rejection estimate in [Proposition B.1](#), and hence the overlap result in [Proposition 3.2](#), are obtained in Lean by an alternative discrete-time proof. Rather than transcribing the continuous-time argument through [Lemmas B.2](#) to [B.5](#) line by line, the formal proof uses finite-dimensional Gaussian likelihood estimates, a coupling between finite Euler schemes and random-walk Metropolis chains, and weak-limit stability. This proves the same stationary-rejection and overlap conclusions, with the parameter dependence needed in the remainder of the paper.

Several parts of the development are stated independently of MALA and may be useful in other formalizations. These reusable results include a lemma deriving the usual Taylor and gradient estimates from two-sided Hessian bounds; the equivalence between the L^2 Poincaré and Rayleigh-quotient definitions of the spectral gap; exact reversibility and Dirichlet-form identities for measurable mixtures of Markov kernels; exact spectral-gap scaling under half-lazification; the fractional and hard-assignment aggregation lemmas for finite families of reversible kernels; spectral-gap upper bounds obtained from L^2 test functions or measurable cuts; and weak-limit stability results for metric-enlargement inequalities and likelihood bounds. The accompanying development contains no proof placeholders or paper-specific axioms.

The Lean package can be found in a GitHub repository [[Qin, 2026](#)].

6 Numerical experiments

We compare fixed-step MALA and uniformly randomized-step MALA on a perturbed-Gaussian target. The simulation package can be found in a GitHub repository [Qin, 2026].

Let h_0 be a positive number and consider a potential function

$$U_{d,h_0}(x) = \frac{m}{2}x_1^2 + \sum_{i=2}^d \left[\frac{L+m}{4}x_i^2 - \frac{(L-m)h_0}{2} \cos\left(\frac{x_i}{\sqrt{h_0}}\right) \right]. \quad (15)$$

In Section A, perturbed Gaussian distributions with densities of the form $e^{-U_{d,h}}$ are investigated from a theoretical perspective. As shown in Proposition A.1, $mI_d \preceq \nabla^2 U_{d,h_0}(x) \preceq LI_d$ for every x . Throughout, $m = 0.1$ and $L = 1$, so $\kappa = 10$. This type of construction appears in Chewi et al. [2021] and Wu et al. [2022], and it serves a hard target for fixed-step MALA.

For an endpoint $H > 0$, we compare a fixed-step MALA P_h with $h = H$ and the randomized-step $\bar{P}_H$. We report the mean acceptance probability $\mathbb{E}[\alpha_h(X, Y)]$ and the expected squared jumping distance per coordinate,

$$\text{ESJD} = \frac{1}{d} \mathbb{E}[\alpha_h(X, Y) \|Y - X\|^2],$$

where X is the current state, and Y is the proposed state. For fixed-step MALA, $Y | X, h \sim Q_h(X, \cdot)$ where $h = H$ is fixed. For randomized-step MALA, $Y | X, h \sim Q_h(X, \cdot)$ and $h \sim \text{Unif}(0, H)$. We will investigate the setting $X = 0$ as well as $X \sim \pi$. To estimate the mean acceptance rate and the ESJD, we use classical Monte Carlo. That is, independent copies of (X, Y, h) are generated, and expectations under the empirical distribution are used as estimates.

6.1 Acceptance at the origin

For each $d \in \{25, 50, 100, 200, 400\}$, we set

$$h_0 = \frac{4}{L\sqrt{d}}$$

and compare fixed-step MALA with $h = h_0$ against randomized-step MALA with $H = h_0$ in terms of the mean acceptance rate at the origin. As shown in Section A, the origin is where fixed-step MALA struggles to leave. Each estimate uses 80,000 independent proposals.

As Figure 1 shows, the fixed-step acceptance probability decreases from approximately 4.92×10^{-3} at $d = 25$ to 1.94×10^{-6} at $d = 400$. The randomized-step acceptance probability decreases much more slowly, from 0.304 to 0.190. Because rejection leaves a chain initialized at the origin unchanged, the time to its first accepted move is geometric. At $d = 400$, the reciprocal acceptance estimates imply mean waiting times of approximately 5.14×10^5 iterations for fixed-step MALA and 5.25 iterations for randomized-step MALA. The experiment therefore directly displays the sticky behavior behind the fixed-step obstruction: proposals at the oscillation scale h_0 have rapidly deteriorating acceptance, whereas uniform randomization retains a substantial probability of selecting a smaller step.

To continue the origin experiment beyond one step, we next examine what happens after fixed-step MALA eventually escapes the hard point. We run one chain of each type for 40,000 iterations on the $d = 200$ target, starting both chains at the origin and taking $H = h_0$. We record the first coordinate at every iteration.

In this realization, the fixed-step chain rejects its first 29,438 proposals and first moves at iteration 29,439. It then makes 5,882 accepted moves by iteration 40,000, so its overall acceptance

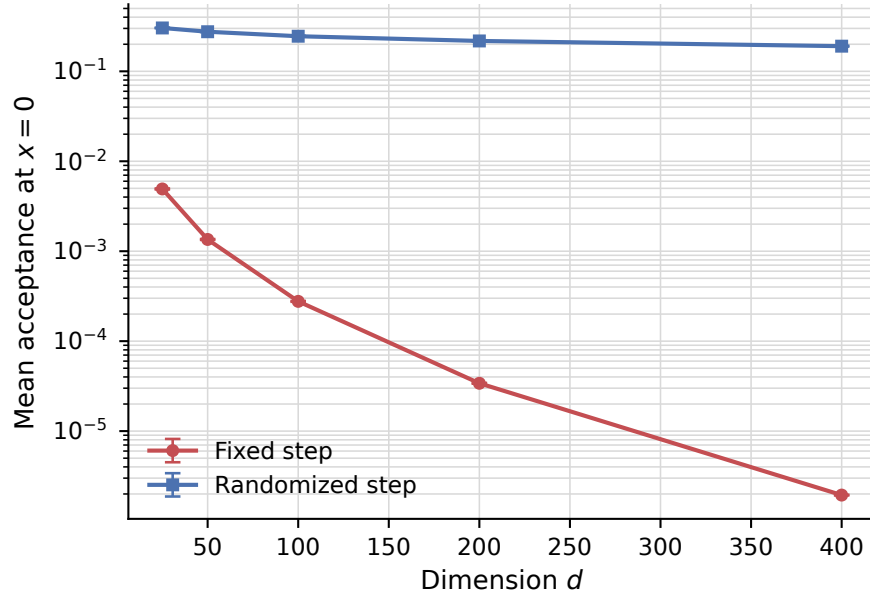


Figure 1: Estimated mean acceptance probability at the origin for the target (15). Fixed-step MALA uses $h = h_0$, while randomized-step MALA uses $h \sim \text{Unif}(0, h_0)$. The vertical axis is logarithmic, and vertical bars show ± 2 estimated standard errors; most are narrower than the markers.

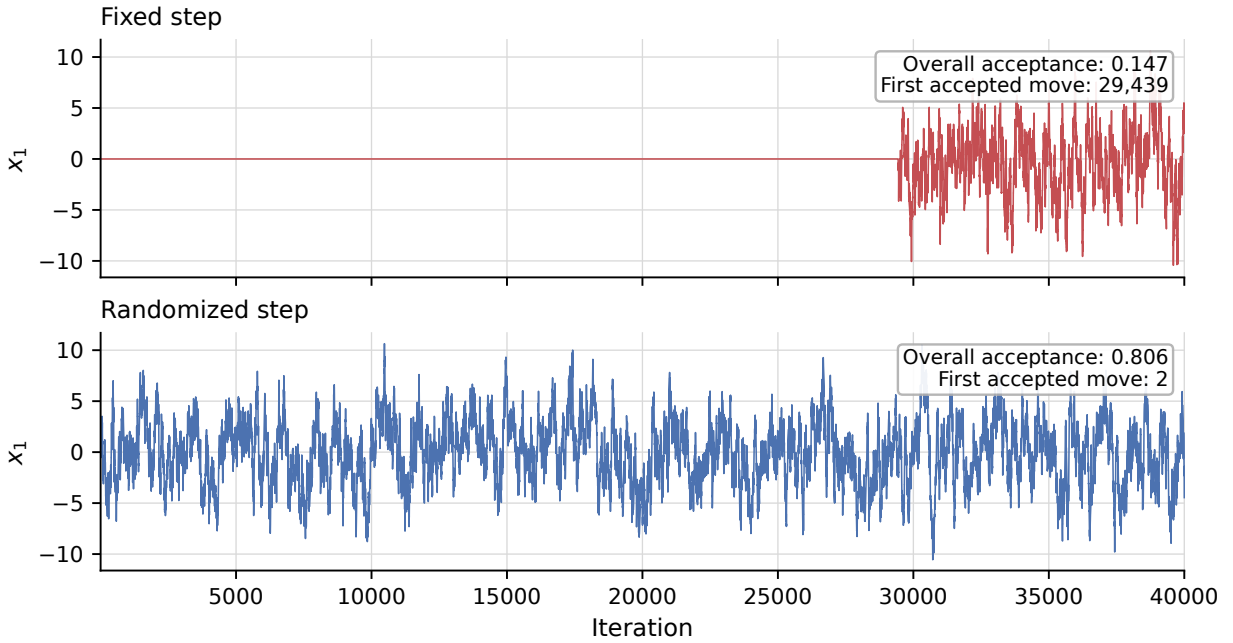


Figure 2: First-coordinate traces continuing the origin experiment for the $d = 200$ hard target, with both chains initialized at the origin and $H = h_0 = 4/\sqrt{200}$. The two panels use common horizontal and vertical scales.

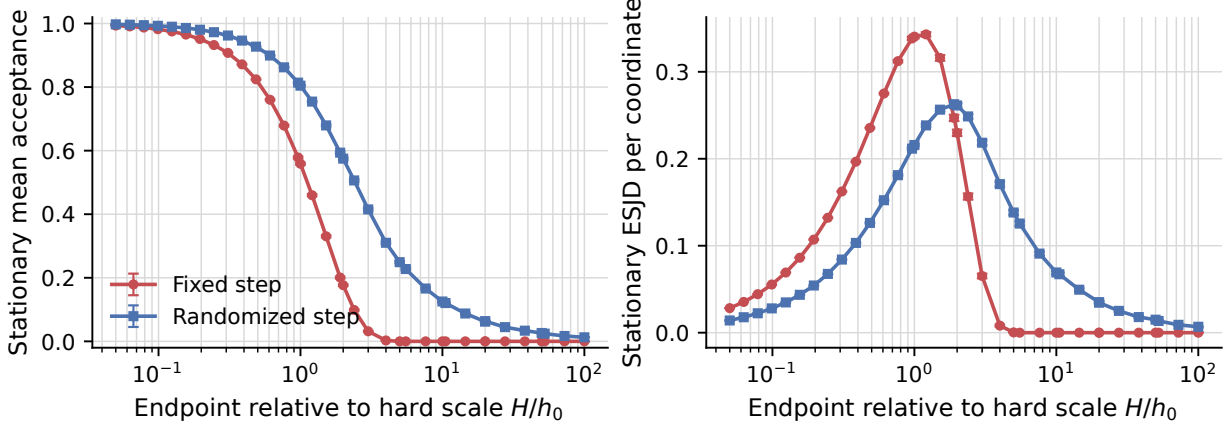


Figure 3: Stationary one-step performance for the $d = 200$ target with $h_0 = 4/\sqrt{200}$. Fixed-step MALA uses $h = H$, while randomized-step MALA uses $h \sim \text{Unif}(0, H)$. Vertical bars show ± 2 estimated standard errors.

rate is 0.147. Over the 10,562-iteration interval from its first accepted move through the end of the run, its empirical acceptance rate is 0.557. The trace therefore shows that, once the fixed chain escapes the sticky point, it begins moving on an ordinary scale; the low overall acceptance rate is dominated by the long initial wait. The randomized chain first moves at iteration 2, makes 32,253 accepted moves, and has overall acceptance rate 0.806.

6.2 Stationary acceptance and jumping distance

The preceding experiment deliberately starts at an atypical point. We next compare average one-step behavior under stationarity. We fix $d = 200$ and $h_0 = 4/\sqrt{200}$, and vary H/h_0 from 0.05 to 100, using a fine grid near the efficient range and a logarithmically spaced grid on the over-tuning side.

Exact stationary samples are available because (15) is a product target. The first coordinate is $N(0, m^{-1})$. For each remaining coordinate, we propose $\tilde{X} \sim N(0, 2/(L + m))$ and accept it with probability

$$\exp \left\{ \frac{(L - m)h_0}{2} \left[\cos \left(\frac{\tilde{X}}{\sqrt{h_0}} \right) - 1 \right] \right\}.$$

This is an exact rejection sampler. At every endpoint H and for each method, we use 48,000 independent stationary one-step experiments.

Figure 3 shows the expected efficiency-robustness tradeoff. At $H = h_0$, fixed-step MALA has acceptance 0.559 and ESJD 0.340, while randomized-step MALA has acceptance 0.804 and ESJD 0.216. The largest observed fixed-step ESJD is 0.343, at $H/h_0 \approx 1.21$, whereas the largest observed randomized-step ESJD is 0.263, at $H/h_0 \approx 1.90$. Thus a well-tuned fixed step has the larger peak ESJD.

Randomization becomes advantageous when the endpoint is too large. At $H = 10h_0$, fixed-step acceptance is approximately 7.49×10^{-46} , whereas randomized-step MALA retains acceptance 0.125 and ESJD 0.0692. Even at $H = 100h_0$, the randomized method has acceptance 0.0127 and ESJD 0.00681, while the corresponding fixed-step estimates are below floating-point resolution. Randomization does not prevent performance from eventually decreasing as H grows, but it changes the abrupt fixed-step collapse into a much more gradual decline.

The two experiments also expose a distinction relevant to the global spectral gap. When $d = 200$

and $H = h_0$, fixed-step acceptance is about 0.559 under stationarity but only 3.40×10^{-5} at the origin. Thus stationary-average diagnostics largely miss the small sticky region, which leads to the exceedingly small spectral gap of fixed-step MALA, as shown in [Section A](#). Uniform randomization improves acceptance both in that region and under over-tuning, although it does not dominate a well-tuned fixed step in stationary ESJD. These one-step experiments illustrate tuning robustness; they do not estimate the spectral gap itself.

Acknowledgment: We thank Guanyang Wang for reading the paper and for providing helpful comments.

Appendices

A Proof of Proposition 2.3

We follow an existing line of research concerning the mixing properties of fixed-step MALA for hard target distributions. A perturbed-Gaussian target constructed in [[Chewi et al., 2021](#), Theorems 8, 9, and 36] forms the basis of our analysis. Subsequently, [Wu et al. \[2022, Equation \(28\) and Lemma 8\]](#) combined a perturbed Gaussian block with a Gaussian coordinate, refining the construction. The two works do not readily yield the spectral gap upper bound in [Proposition 2.3](#). Below, we use a modified version of the construction in [Wu et al. \[2022\]](#) to derive the upper bound.

Proposition A.1. *There are universal constants $c, C > 0$ such that the following holds. Let $d \geq 2$, $0 < m < L$, and $h > 0$. Define*

$$U_{d,h}(x) = \frac{m}{2}x_1^2 + \sum_{i=2}^d \left[\frac{L+m}{4}x_i^2 - \frac{(L-m)h}{2} \cos\left(\frac{x_i}{\sqrt{h}}\right) \right]. \quad (16)$$

Then $U_{d,h}$ is infinitely differentiable and

$$mI_d \preceq \nabla^2 U_{d,h}(x) \preceq LI_d, \quad x \in \mathbb{R}^d. \quad (17)$$

If P_h is the MALA kernel with step size h and target density proportional to $e^{-U_{d,h}}$, then

$$\text{Gap}_R(P_h) \leq C \min \left\{ mh + \frac{(mh)^2}{2}, \exp[-c(d-1) \min\{(L-m)h, 1\}] \right\}. \quad (18)$$

Writing $\kappa = L/m$, this further implies, after possibly changing the universal constants c and C , that

$$\text{Gap}_R(P_h) \leq C \min \left\{ \kappa^{-1}Lh, \exp[-cd \min\{(1-\kappa^{-1})Lh, 1\}] \right\}. \quad (19)$$

Proof. For $i \geq 2$, the i th diagonal entry of the Hessian of $U_{d,h}$ is

$$\frac{L+m}{2} + \frac{L-m}{2} \cos\left(\frac{x_i}{\sqrt{h}}\right),$$

which lies in $[m, L]$. The first diagonal entry equals m , and all off-diagonal entries vanish. This proves (17).

We first establish the local upper bound. The target is a product measure, and its first marginal is $N(0, m^{-1})$. Use $f(x) = x_1$ in the Poincaré quotient. Let X have the target distribution, let $Z \sim N_d(0, I_d)$ be independent of X , and write

$$\tilde{Y} = X - h\nabla U_{d,h}(X) + \sqrt{2h} Z$$

for the MALA proposal. The actual transition either moves to $\tilde{Y}$ or remains at X . Consequently,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{E}_{P_h}(f, f) &\leq \frac{1}{2} \mathbb{E} \left[(-hmX_1 + \sqrt{2h} Z_1)^2 \right] \\ &= \frac{1}{2} (h^2 m + 2h), \end{aligned}$$

where we used $\mathbb{E}(X_1^2) = m^{-1}$ and the independence of X_1 and Z_1 . Since $\text{Var}_\pi(f) = m^{-1}$, it follows that

$$\text{Gap}_R(P_h) \leq mh + \frac{(mh)^2}{2}. \quad (20)$$

We next obtain the exponential upper bound by controlling the mean acceptance probability at the origin. Write

$$a = \frac{L+m}{2}, \quad b = \frac{L-m}{2}.$$

At the origin, $\nabla U_{d,h}(0) = 0$, so a proposal has the form

$$Y = \sqrt{2h} Z.$$

For a general differentiable potential U , the log Hastings ratio for a proposal from x to y is

$$\begin{aligned} R_h(x, y) &:= \log \frac{e^{-U(y)} q_h(y, x)}{e^{-U(x)} q_h(x, y)} \\ &= U(x) - U(y) + \frac{1}{2} \langle y - x, \nabla U(x) + \nabla U(y) \rangle \\ &\quad + \frac{h}{4} [\|\nabla U(x)\|^2 - \|\nabla U(y)\|^2]. \end{aligned} \quad (21)$$

For $i = 2, \dots, d$, put

$$V_i = \frac{Y_i}{\sqrt{h}} = \sqrt{2} Z_i.$$

Substituting (16) into (21) gives

$$\begin{aligned} R_h(0, Y) &= -\frac{m^2 h^2}{2} Z_1^2 + bh \sum_{i=2}^d A(V_i) \\ &\quad - \frac{h^2}{4} \sum_{i=2}^d [aV_i + b \sin(V_i)]^2, \end{aligned} \quad (22)$$

where

$$A(v) = \cos v - 1 + \frac{v \sin v}{2}.$$

Both the first and the last terms in (22) are nonpositive.

Since $V_i \sim N(0, 2)$,

$$\mathbb{E}(\cos V_i) = e^{-1}, \quad \mathbb{E}(V_i \sin V_i) = 2e^{-1}.$$

The first identity follows from the characteristic function of V_i , and the second follows from Stein's identity. Hence

$$\mathbb{E}[A(V_i)] = \frac{2}{e} - 1 = -a_0, \quad a_0 = 1 - \frac{2}{e} > 0.$$

Moreover,

$$|A(v)| \leq 2 + \frac{|v|}{2}.$$

Thus $A(V_i) - \mathbb{E}[A(V_i)]$ has a universally bounded sub-Gaussian norm; see, for example, [Vershynin, 2018, Section 2.5.2]. The concentration inequality for sums of independent sub-Gaussian random variables [Vershynin, 2018, Theorem 2.6.3] therefore yields a universal constant $c_0 > 0$ such that

$$\mathbb{P}\left(\sum_{i=2}^d A(V_i) > -\frac{a_0(d-1)}{2}\right) \leq e^{-c_0(d-1)}. \quad (23)$$

Outside the event in (23),

$$R_h(0, Y) \leq -\frac{a_0}{2}bh(d-1) = -\frac{a_0}{4}(d-1)(L-m)h.$$

Let

$$a_h(x) = \int \alpha_h(x, y) Q_h(x, dy)$$

denote the pointwise acceptance probability. It follows that

$$\begin{aligned} a_h(0) &= \mathbb{E}\left[1 \wedge e^{R_h(0, Y)}\right] \\ &\leq \exp\left[-\frac{a_0}{4}(d-1)(L-m)h\right] + e^{-c_0(d-1)} \\ &\leq 2 \exp[-c_1(d-1) \min\{(L-m)h, 1\}] \end{aligned}$$

for a universal constant $c_1 > 0$.

The function $x \mapsto a_h(x)$ is continuous. Indeed, writing the proposal as

$$x - h\nabla U_{d,h}(x) + \sqrt{2h} Z, \quad Z \sim N_d(0, I_d),$$

the resulting acceptance probability is continuous in x for every fixed Z and is bounded by one. Continuity therefore follows from dominated convergence.

Consequently, there is an open ball S centered at the origin such that

$$0 < \pi(S) \leq \frac{1}{2}, \quad \sup_{x \in S} a_h(x) \leq 4 \exp[-c_1(d-1) \min\{(L-m)h, 1\}].$$

A transition starting in S can leave S only if its proposal is accepted. Hence

$$\mathcal{J}_{P_h}(S, S^c) \leq 4 \exp[-c_1(d-1) \min\{(L-m)h, 1\}] \pi(S).$$

Testing the Poincaré quotient with $\mathbf{1}_S$ gives

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Gap}_R(P_h) &\leq \frac{\mathcal{E}_{P_h}(\mathbf{1}_S, \mathbf{1}_S)}{\text{Var}_\pi(\mathbf{1}_S)} \\ &= \frac{\mathcal{J}_{P_h}(S, S^c)}{\pi(S)[1 - \pi(S)]} \end{aligned}$$

$$\leq 8 \exp[-c_1(d-1) \min\{(L-m)h, 1\}]. \quad (24)$$

Combining (20) and (24) proves (18).

Finally, we prove (19). We have

$$L - m = (1 - \kappa^{-1})L, \quad d - 1 \geq \frac{d}{2}.$$

Therefore

$$(d-1) \min\{(L-m)h, 1\} \geq \frac{d}{2} \min\{(1 - \kappa^{-1})Lh, 1\}.$$

If $mh \leq 1$, then

$$mh + \frac{(mh)^2}{2} \leq \frac{3}{2}mh = \frac{3}{2}\kappa^{-1}Lh.$$

If $mh > 1$, then

$$\exp[-cd \min\{(1 - \kappa^{-1})Lh, 1\}] \leq 1 < mh = \kappa^{-1}Lh,$$

so the exponential bound is the smaller of the two terms in (19). After adjusting the universal constants, this proves (19). $\square$

We can now prove Proposition 2.3.

Proof. By Proposition A.1, there are universal constants $c_0, C_0 > 0$ such that, for every $h > 0$,

$$\inf_{\substack{U \in C^\infty(\mathbb{R}^d) \\ mI_d \preceq \nabla^2 U(x) \preceq LI_d, \ x \in \mathbb{R}^d}} \text{Gap}_R(P_{U,h}) \leq F(Lh), \quad (25)$$

where

$$F(t) = C_0 \min \left\{ \kappa^{-1}t, \exp \left[-c_0 d \min\{(1 - \kappa^{-1})t, 1\} \right] \right\}.$$

Set

$$t_\star = \frac{2 \log(\kappa d)}{c_0(1 - \kappa^{-1})d}.$$

If $0 < t \leq t_\star$, then

$$F(t) \leq C_0 \kappa^{-1}t_\star = \frac{2C_0 \log(\kappa d)}{c_0(1 - \kappa^{-1})\kappa d}.$$

If $t > t_\star$, then the exponential term defining F is nonincreasing in t , and hence

$$\begin{aligned} F(t) &\leq C_0 \exp \left[-c_0 d \min\{(1 - \kappa^{-1})t_\star, 1\} \right] \\ &= C_0 \max \left\{ \frac{1}{(\kappa d)^2}, e^{-c_0 d} \right\}. \end{aligned}$$

Consequently,

$$\begin{aligned} \sup_{t>0} F(t) &\leq C_0 \max \left\{ \frac{2 \log(\kappa d)}{c_0(1 - \kappa^{-1})\kappa d}, \frac{1}{(\kappa d)^2}, e^{-c_0 d} \right\} \\ &\leq C_0 \max \left\{ \frac{2 \log(\kappa d)}{c_0(1 - \kappa_0^{-1})\kappa d}, \frac{1}{(\kappa d)^2}, e^{-c_0 d} \right\}. \end{aligned} \quad (26)$$

Because $d \geq 2$ and $\kappa > 1$,

$$\frac{1}{(\kappa d)^2} \leq C \frac{\log(\kappa d)}{\kappa d}$$

for a universal constant C . Absorbing the factors depending only on κ_0 into C , and changing the universal exponential constant if necessary, (25) and (26) prove (3). $\square$

B Proof of Proposition 3.2

This appendix proves [Proposition 3.2](#). The main input is the following stationary estimate for the pointwise rejection function

$$r_h(x) = 1 - \int \alpha_h(x, y) Q_h(x, dy),$$

where

$$\alpha_h(x, y) = 1 \wedge \frac{e^{-U(y)} q_h(y, x)}{e^{-U(x)} q_h(x, y)}, \quad q_h(x, y) = (4\pi h)^{-d/2} \exp \left\{ -\frac{\|y - x + h \nabla U(x)\|^2}{4h} \right\}.$$

Proposition B.1. *There are universal constants $c, C > 0$ such that, for every real $p \geq 2$,*

$$h \leq \frac{c}{L\sqrt{p(d+p)}} \implies \|r_h\|_{L^p(\pi)} \leq CLh\sqrt{p(d+p)}. \quad (27)$$

The proof of [Proposition B.1](#) compares the exact stationary Langevin path with the path whose drift is frozen at its initial position. The endpoint of the latter path is exactly the MALA proposal. Similar diffusion-comparison ideas appear in [Bou-Rabee and Vanden-Eijnden \[2010\]](#), [Bou-Rabee and Hairer \[2013\]](#), [Chewi et al. \[2021\]](#).

The idea behind the proof is roughly as follows. Let $X_0 \sim \pi$, and suppose that, on a filtered probability space $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, (\mathcal{F}_t)_{t \geq 0}, \mathbb{P})$, X_t solves the Langevin equation

$$dX_t = -\nabla U(X_t) dt + \sqrt{2} dB_t, \quad (28)$$

where B_t is a Brownian motion. Standard theory of Langevin diffusion implies $X_h \sim \pi$. Denote by S_h the conditional distribution of X_h given X_0 . We compare $S_h(x, dy)$ to the proposal $Q_h(x, dy)$, which gives the Gaussian law $N_d(x - h \nabla U(x), 2hI_d)$. Define $\nu_h(dx, dy) = \pi(dx) S_h(x, dy)$, $\mu_h(dx, dy) = \pi(dx) Q_h(x, dy)$. Assume that the Radon-Nikodym derivative $F_h = d\mu_h/d\nu_h$ is well-defined. It can be argued that, for π -a.e. x , $F_h(x, \cdot) = dQ_h(x, \cdot)/dS_h(x, \cdot)$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} r_h(x) &= \int S_h(x, dy) \left[1 - F_h(x, y) \min \left\{ 1, \frac{F_h(y, x)}{F_h(x, y)} \right\} \right] \\ &\leq \int (|F_h(x, y) - 1| + |F_h(y, x) - 1|) S_h(x, dy). \end{aligned}$$

Using Jensen's inequality and the fact that ν_h is symmetric (which holds because the Langevin diffusion is π -reversible), one can now show that $\|r_h\|_{L^p(\pi)}$ can be controlled by $2\|F_h - 1\|_{L^p(\nu_h)}$.

To find F_h , let

$$dW_t = dB_t - \theta_t dt, \quad \theta_t = \frac{\nabla U(X_t) - \nabla U(X_0)}{\sqrt{2}}$$

Then X_t has the frozen drift representation $dX_t = -\nabla U(X_0)dt + \sqrt{2}dW_t$. Suppose that one can find an alternative probability measure $\mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}$ defined by a Radon-Nikodym derivative $D_h = d\mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}/d\mathbb{P}|_{\mathcal{F}_h}$ such that, under $\mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}$, W_t is a Brownian motion with respect to $(\mathcal{F}_t)_{0 \leq t \leq h}$. Then, under this new probability measure, (X_0, X_h) is distributed as μ_h . In particular, with expectations defined in terms of $\mathbb{P}$, $F_h(X_0, X_h) = \mathbb{E}[D_h | \sigma(X_0, X_h)]$, so conditional Jensen's inequality would imply that $\|F_h - 1\|_{L^p(\nu_h)} \leq \|D_h - 1\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})}$. As stated in [Lemma B.4](#), one can construct the desired measure $\mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}$ by letting D_h be defined through the stochastic exponential

$$D_t = \exp \left(\int_0^t \langle \theta_s, dB_s \rangle - \frac{1}{2} V_t \right), \quad V_t = \int_0^t \|\theta_s\|^2 ds,$$

provided that $(D_t)_{0 \leq t \leq h}$ is a true martingale. This is a consequence of Girsanov's theorem [see, e.g., Karatzas and Shreve, 1991, Revuz and Yor, 1999]. Therefore, to prove [Proposition B.1](#), it comes down to two tasks: showing that D_t is a true martingale, and that $\|D_h - 1\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} \leq CLh\sqrt{p(d+p)}$ when $h \leq c/(L\sqrt{p(d+p)})$, where c, C are appropriate universal constants.

To show that D_t is a martingale, it suffices to establish Novikov's criterion: $\mathbb{E}(e^{V_h/2}) < \infty$. Since ∇U is L -Lipschitz, one can bound V_h by $L^2 J_h/2$, where $J_h = \int_0^h \|X_t - X_0\|^2 dt$. This prompts us to bound $\mathbb{E}(e^{\lambda J_h})$ for some suitable $\lambda \geq 0$ in [Lemma B.3](#).

We obtain the upper bound $\|D_h - 1\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} \leq CLh\sqrt{p(d+p)}$ for $h \leq c/(L\sqrt{p(d+p)})$ in [Lemma B.5](#). In the proof of [Lemma B.5](#), we apply Itô's formula, Burkholder-Davis-Gundy (BDG) inequality, and Doob's maximal inequality to obtain what is loosely

$$\|D_h - 1\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} \leq C' \sqrt{p} \|V_h\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})}^{1/2} \leq 2^{-1/2} C' L \sqrt{p} \|J_h\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})}^{1/2},$$

where C' is universal. This prompts us to study $\|J_h\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})}$ and obtain an upper bound that is of order $h^2(d+p)$ in [Lemma B.3](#).

To establish the bounds in [Lemma B.3](#), we first control $X_t - X_0$ using stationary reversibility in [Lemma B.2](#), without explicitly solving the Langevin equation.

Once [Proposition B.1](#) is established, we can utilize elementary techniques in the MCMC literature [see, e.g., Wu et al., 2022, proof of Theorem 3] to establish [Proposition 3.2](#).

Attribution within this appendix. The estimate in [Lemma B.2](#) is an elementary consequence of the Lyons–Zheng forward–backward decomposition [Lyons and Zheng, 1988, Section 1, especially equation (1.7)]; see also Fukushima et al. [2011, Theorem 5.7.1]. For the Langevin diffusion considered here, the required decomposition follows directly from the stochastic differential equation and stationary reversibility, as shown below. [Lemma B.3](#) then follows from that estimate, Gaussian randomization, and Jensen's inequality. The Gaussian-randomization step is the identity-matrix specialization of the argument used for sub-Gaussian quadratic forms by Hsu et al. [2012, Theorem 1 and Remark 2]. [Lemma B.5](#) combines standard results on stochastic exponentials, Novikov's criterion, Girsanov's theorem, stopping of stochastic integrals, Doob's inequality, and the quantitative BDG inequality, with the problem-specific estimate $V_h \leq L^2 J_h/2$. General reverse-Hölder theory for continuous stochastic exponentials is developed by Kazamaki [1994], but the dimension- and moment-explicit calculation needed here is supplied in full. The passage from the path likelihood to the rejection probability uses the standard conditional-likelihood identity and the Metropolis–Hastings meet identity [Kallenberg, 2021, Tierney, 1998, Billera and Diaconis, 2001]. Thus [Proposition B.1](#) combines these ingredients for the present MALA problem.

B.1 Controlling Langevin increments

The goal of this subsection is to control the magnitude of $X_t - X_0$, particularly the time integral $\int_0^h \|X_t - X_0\|^2 dt$, where X_t satisfies (28).

We begin by fixing the continuous-time framework used throughout this appendix. All random variables are defined on a filtered probability space

$$(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, (\mathcal{F}_t)_{t \geq 0}, \mathbb{P})$$

satisfying the usual completeness and right-continuity conditions. A standard d -dimensional Brownian motion relative to this filtration is an adapted continuous process B with $B_0 = 0$ such that, for $0 \leq s < t$, the increment $B_t - B_s$ has law $N_d(0, (t-s)I_d)$ and is independent of $\mathcal{F}_s$. This last independence property will be used explicitly in [Section B.2](#). Basic references for filtered probability

spaces, Brownian motion, Itô integration, and stochastic differential equations are [Karatzas and Shreve \[1991, Chapters 3 and 5\]](#), [Revuz and Yor \[1999, Chapters IV and IX\]](#), and [Kallenberg \[2021\]](#).

Because ∇U is globally Lipschitz, for every $x \in \mathbb{R}^d$ the Langevin equation has a unique nonexplosive strong solution $(X_t^x)_{t \geq 0}$ with $X_0^x = x$; see, for example, [Karatzas and Shreve \[1991, Chapter 5\]](#). For a bounded measurable function f , define the transition semigroup by

$$S_t f(x) = \mathbb{E}[f(X_t^x)].$$

Now let X_0 be $\mathcal{F}_0$ -measurable and independent of B , with law π , and let $(X_t)_{t \geq 0}$ be the corresponding solution of

$$dX_t = -\nabla U(X_t) dt + \sqrt{2} dB_t, \quad X_0 \sim \pi. \quad (29)$$

The differential notation means the integral identity

$$X_t = X_0 - \int_0^t \nabla U(X_s) ds + \sqrt{2} B_t, \quad t \geq 0. \quad (30)$$

Under the standing assumptions on U , the Langevin semigroup is symmetric with respect to $\pi(dx) \propto e^{-U(x)} dx$:

$$\int f S_t g d\pi = \int g S_t f d\pi$$

for bounded measurable f, g and $t \geq 0$; see [Fukushima et al. \[2011, Chapters 1 and 7\]](#) and [Bakry et al. \[2014\]](#). Since $S_t 1 = 1$, taking $f = 1$ shows that π is invariant. Consequently, the process started from $X_0 \sim \pi$ is stationary and reversible.

Lemma B.2. *For every $v \in \mathbb{R}^d$, $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$, and $t \geq 0$,*

$$\mathbb{E}[\exp(\lambda \langle v, X_t - X_0 \rangle)] \leq \exp(\lambda^2 t \|v\|^2). \quad (31)$$

Proof. The case $t = 0$ is immediate. Fix $t > 0$. Stationarity and reversibility give

$$(X_s)_{0 \leq s \leq t} \stackrel{d}{=} (X_{t-s})_{0 \leq s \leq t}$$

as random elements of $C([0, t]; \mathbb{R}^d)$. Set

$$Z = X_0 - X_t + \int_0^t \nabla U(X_s) ds.$$

Reversing the path interchanges X_0 and X_t , while leaving the time integral unchanged, since

$$\int_0^t \nabla U(X_{t-s}) ds = \int_0^t \nabla U(X_s) ds.$$

The equality of path laws and (30) therefore give

$$Z \stackrel{d}{=} X_t - X_0 + \int_0^t \nabla U(X_s) ds = \sqrt{2} B_t \sim N_d(0, 2tI_d).$$

Moreover, subtracting the definition of Z from the preceding expression for $\sqrt{2} B_t$ yields

$$X_t - X_0 = \frac{\sqrt{2} B_t - Z}{2}.$$

Thus the drift integral cancels when the forward and reversed expressions are subtracted.

By convexity of the exponential function,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[\exp(\lambda \langle v, X_t - X_0 \rangle)] &= \mathbb{E} \left[\exp \left(\frac{\lambda}{2} \langle v, \sqrt{2} B_t - Z \rangle \right) \right] \\ &\leq \frac{1}{2} \mathbb{E}[\exp(\sqrt{2} \lambda \langle v, B_t \rangle)] + \frac{1}{2} \mathbb{E}[\exp(-\lambda \langle v, Z \rangle)] \\ &= \exp(\lambda^2 t \|v\|^2).\end{aligned}$$

The last equality uses the Gaussian moment-generating formula. No independence between B_t and Z is required, and the finite Gaussian exponential moments justify the inequality without any preliminary integrability assumption on its left-hand side. $\square$

The next proof uses a standard Gaussian-randomization argument. In a more general matrix form, it is the argument used by [Hsu et al. \[2012, Theorem 1 and Remark 2\]](#) to pass from linear sub-Gaussian moment bounds to quadratic-form bounds. We include the identity-matrix calculation because the exact constant in (32) is useful below.

Lemma B.3. *For every $t > 0$ and $0 \leq a < 1/(4t)$,*

$$\mathbb{E}[\exp(a \|X_t - X_0\|^2)] \leq (1 - 4at)^{-d/2}. \quad (32)$$

If

$$J_h = \int_0^h \|X_t - X_0\|^2 dt,$$

then, for $0 \leq \lambda < 1/(4h^2)$,

$$\mathbb{E}(e^{\lambda J_h}) \leq (1 - 4\lambda h^2)^{-d/2}. \quad (33)$$

Consequently, for every real $p \geq 1$,

$$\|J_h\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} \leq Ch^2(d + p), \quad (34)$$

where C is universal.

Proof. Enlarge the probability space, if necessary, so that it also carries a random vector $G \sim N_d(0, I_d)$ independent of the entire Langevin path $(X_s)_{s \geq 0}$. For a fixed vector $z \in \mathbb{R}^d$, the scalar $\langle G, z \rangle$ is Gaussian with mean zero and variance $\|z\|^2$. The Gaussian moment-generating formula therefore gives

$$\mathbb{E}(e^{\sqrt{2a} \langle G, z \rangle}) = e^{a\|z\|^2}.$$

Apply this identity with the random vector $z = X_t - X_0$. More precisely, conditioning first on the Langevin path gives

$$\mathbb{E}(e^{a\|X_t - X_0\|^2}) = \mathbb{E} \left\{ \mathbb{E} \left[e^{\sqrt{2a} \langle G, X_t - X_0 \rangle} \mid \sigma(X_s : s \geq 0) \right] \right\}.$$

The integrand is nonnegative, so Tonelli's theorem allows us to reverse the order in which the path and G are averaged. Conditional on G , the vector G is fixed, and [Lemma B.2](#), with $v = G$ and $\lambda = \sqrt{2a}$, gives

$$\mathbb{E}(e^{\sqrt{2a} \langle G, X_t - X_0 \rangle} \mid G) \leq e^{2at\|G\|^2}.$$

Consequently,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}\left(e^{a\|X_t-X_0\|^2}\right) &\leq \mathbb{E}\left(e^{2at\|G\|^2}\right) \\ &= (1-4at)^{-d/2},\end{aligned}$$

where the last equality is the moment-generating function of a χ_d^2 random variable and requires $4at < 1$. This proves (32).

We next pass from one increment to its time integral. For each fixed sample path, Jensen's inequality for the convex function $x \mapsto e^x$, applied to the uniform probability measure dt/h on $[0, h]$, gives

$$\begin{aligned}e^{\lambda J_h} &= \exp\left(\frac{1}{h} \int_0^h \lambda h \|X_t - X_0\|^2 dt\right) \\ &\leq \frac{1}{h} \int_0^h e^{\lambda h \|X_t - X_0\|^2} dt.\end{aligned}$$

Take expectations and use Tonelli's theorem, followed by (32) with $a = \lambda h$:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}(e^{\lambda J_h}) &\leq \frac{1}{h} \int_0^h \mathbb{E}(e^{\lambda h \|X_t - X_0\|^2}) dt \\ &\leq \frac{1}{h} \int_0^h (1 - 4\lambda h t)^{-d/2} dt \\ &\leq (1 - 4\lambda h^2)^{-d/2}.\end{aligned}$$

This proves (33).

It remains to derive the L^p estimate from this exponential-tail bound. Put $\lambda = (8h^2)^{-1}$ in (33). Markov's inequality gives, for every $s \geq 0$,

$$\mathbb{P}\left(J_h \geq 4dh^2 \log 2 + 8h^2 s\right) \leq e^{-s}.$$

Define

$$Y = \frac{(J_h - 4dh^2 \log 2)_+}{8h^2}.$$

Then $\mathbb{P}(Y > s) \leq e^{-s}$. For every real $p \geq 1$, the layer-cake formula for moments gives

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}(Y^p) &= p \int_0^\infty s^{p-1} \mathbb{P}(Y > s) ds \\ &\leq p \int_0^\infty s^{p-1} e^{-s} ds = \Gamma(p+1).\end{aligned}$$

Stirling's bound implies $\Gamma(p+1)^{1/p} \leq Cp$ for all $p \geq 1$. Hence, by the Minkowski inequality,

$$\|J_h\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} \leq 4dh^2 \log 2 + 8h^2 \|Y\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} \leq Ch^2(d+p),$$

which proves (34). For the tail-integration identity and the Gamma-function estimate, see [Boucheron et al. \[2013, Chapter 2\]](#). $\square$

B.2 Girsanov comparison with frozen drift

We compare two laws on the same path space over $[0, h]$. Under the probability measure $\mathbb{P}$, the path satisfies the exact Langevin equation (29). We shall construct a second measure under which the coordinate process has drift frozen at the initial value $-\nabla U(X_0)$.

We recall the continuous-martingale facts used below. If H_t is a predictable $\mathbb{R}^d$ -valued process with $\int_0^h \|H_t\|^2 dt < \infty$ almost surely, then $\int_0^t \langle H_s, dB_s \rangle$ is a continuous local martingale. Its quadratic variation is

$$\left[\int_0^\cdot \langle H_s, dB_s \rangle \right]_t = \int_0^t \|H_s\|^2 ds.$$

For a continuous local martingale N with $N_0 = 0$, the stochastic exponential is

$$\mathcal{E}(N)_t = \exp(N_t - [N]_t/2).$$

It is always a nonnegative local martingale, but it need not have expectation one. Novikov's criterion states that $\mathbb{E} \exp([N]_h/2) < \infty$ is sufficient for $(\mathcal{E}(N)_t)_{0 \leq t \leq h}$ to be a true mean-one martingale. These statements, together with Itô's formula and the stopping arguments used below, are standard; see Karatzas and Shreve [1991, Chapter 3], Revuz and Yor [1999, Chapters IV and VIII], or Kallenberg [2021].

Under the exact stationary law, define

$$\theta_t = \frac{\nabla U(X_t) - \nabla U(X_0)}{\sqrt{2}}, \quad V_t = \int_0^t \|\theta_s\|^2 ds, \quad M_t = \int_0^t \langle \theta_s, dB_s \rangle.$$

The process θ_t is continuous and adapted, hence predictable. Since X has continuous paths, $\int_0^h \|\theta_s\|^2 ds < \infty$ almost surely on every finite interval, so the Itô integral is well defined as a continuous local martingale. Its quadratic variation is $[M]_t = V_t$. The Lipschitz property of ∇U and Lemma B.3 give

$$V_h \leq \frac{L^2}{2} J_h, \quad \|V_h\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} \leq CL^2 h^2 (d+p) \text{ whenever } p \geq 1. \quad (35)$$

Define the stochastic exponential

$$D_t = \exp \left(M_t - \frac{1}{2} V_t \right) = \mathcal{E}(M)_t.$$

The following lemma collects the change-of-measure construction and the endpoint identification that will be used in the proof of Proposition B.1.

Lemma B.4. *Assume that $h > 0$ and $Lh < 1$. Then $(D_t)_{0 \leq t \leq h}$ is a true mean-one $\mathbb{P}$ -martingale, and*

$$\left. \frac{d\mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}}{d\mathbb{P}} \right|_{\mathcal{F}_h} = D_h \quad (36)$$

defines a probability measure $\mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}$ on $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}_h)$. Under $\mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}$, the process

$$W_t = B_t - \int_0^t \theta_s ds, \quad 0 \leq t \leq h,$$

is a Brownian motion relative to $(\mathcal{F}_t)_{0 \leq t \leq h}$, and

$$X_t = X_0 - t \nabla U(X_0) + \sqrt{2} W_t, \quad 0 \leq t \leq h. \quad (37)$$

Moreover, under $\mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}$, $X_0 \sim \pi$, and a version of the conditional law of X_h given $X_0 = x$ is $Q_h(x, \cdot)$. It follows that, for all Borel sets $A, B \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$,

$$\mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}(X_0 \in A, X_h \in B) = \int_A Q_h(x, B) \pi(dx). \quad (38)$$

Proof. By (33) and (35),

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[\exp([M]_h/2)] &= \mathbb{E}[\exp(V_h/2)] \\ &\leq \mathbb{E}\left[\exp\left(L^2 J_h/4\right)\right] \\ &\leq (1 - L^2 h^2)^{-d/2} < \infty, \end{aligned}$$

where the last inequality uses $Lh < 1$. Novikov's criterion therefore shows that D is a true mean-one $\mathbb{P}$ -martingale. In particular,

$$\mathbb{E}(D_t \mid \mathcal{F}_s) = D_s, \quad 0 \leq s \leq t \leq h, \quad (39)$$

and (36) defines a probability measure.

Girsanov's theorem gives the asserted Brownian motion W_t ; see Karatzas and Shreve [1991, Section 3.5] or Revuz and Yor [1999, Chapter VIII, Section 1]. Substituting

$$B_t = W_t + \int_0^t \theta_s ds$$

into (30) yields

$$\begin{aligned} X_t &= X_0 - \int_0^t \nabla U(X_s) ds + \sqrt{2} W_t + \sqrt{2} \int_0^t \theta_s ds \\ &= X_0 - t \nabla U(X_0) + \sqrt{2} W_t, \end{aligned}$$

which proves (37).

For every Borel set $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}(X_0 \in A) &= \mathbb{E}\left(D_h \mathbf{1}_{\{X_0 \in A\}}\right) \\ &= \mathbb{E}\left[\mathbb{E}(D_h \mid \mathcal{F}_0) \mathbf{1}_{\{X_0 \in A\}}\right] \\ &= \mathbb{P}(X_0 \in A) = \pi(A), \end{aligned}$$

where (39) gives $\mathbb{E}[D_h \mid \mathcal{F}_0] = D_0 = 1$.

Under $\mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}$, the increment $W_h - W_0 = W_h$ is independent of $\mathcal{F}_0$ and has law $N_d(0, hI_d)$. Since X_0 is $\mathcal{F}_0$ -measurable, (37) gives, conditionally on $X_0 = x$,

$$X_h = x - h \nabla U(x) + \sqrt{2h} Z, \quad Z \sim N_d(0, I_d).$$

This is precisely the kernel $Q_h(x, \cdot)$. Combining this conditional law with $X_0 \sim \pi$ proves (38). $\square$

We next quantify how close the path likelihood D_h is to one. General reverse-Hölder and moment estimates for continuous stochastic exponentials form a classical theory; see, for example, Kazamaki [1994, Chapters 1 and 3]. We give a direct localized calculation to track explicitly the dependence on d, p, L , and h and to exploit the problem-specific bound $V_h \leq L^2 J_h/2$.

Lemma B.5. *There are universal constants $c, C > 0$ such that, for every $h > 0$ and every real $p \geq 2$, the conditions*

$$Lh < 1, \quad h \leq \frac{c}{L\sqrt{p(d+p)}} \quad (40)$$

imply

$$\|D_h\|_{L^{2p}(\mathbb{P})} \leq C, \quad \|D_h - 1\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} \leq CLh\sqrt{p(d+p)}. \quad (41)$$

Proof. Stopping conventions. We use standard process-level stopping identities. If N_t is a continuous local martingale and τ is a stopping time, then, up to indistinguishability,

$$N_t^\tau := N_{t \wedge \tau}, \quad [N^\tau]_t = [N]_{t \wedge \tau}.$$

Likewise, for a predictable integrand H_t ,

$$\left(\int_0^\cdot \langle H_s, dB_s \rangle \right)_{t \wedge \tau} = \int_0^t \mathbf{1}_{\{s \leq \tau\}} \langle H_s, dB_s \rangle. \quad (42)$$

These are identities of stopped processes and therefore hold for all t simultaneously outside a single null set; continuity then permits evaluation at any bounded random time. Purely algebraic identities among continuous processes may be evaluated at $t \wedge \tau$ for the same reason, and inequalities such as $V_{t \wedge \tau} \leq V_t$ follow pathwise from monotonicity. By contrast, an estimate obtained only after taking expectations at each fixed time cannot generally be evaluated at a stopping time without a separate optional-stopping argument. No such step is used here. See [Revuz and Yor \[1999, Chapter IV, Sections 1–2\]](#), [Karatzas and Shreve \[1991, Chapter 3\]](#), or [Protter \[2005, Chapter II\]](#) for stopping of continuous local martingales, stochastic integrals, and quadratic variation.

Step 1: a uniform L^{2p} bound for D_h . For $n \geq 1$, let

$$\tau_n = \inf\{t \in [0, h] : V_t \geq n\}, \quad \inf \emptyset = \infty.$$

Because V is continuous and adapted, τ_n is a stopping time. Set $M_t^{(n)} = M_{t \wedge \tau_n}$. By the standard stopping identity for quadratic variation stated above,

$$[M^{(n)}]_t = [M]_{t \wedge \tau_n} = V_{t \wedge \tau_n}.$$

Consequently, the quadratic variation of the continuous local martingale $4pM^{(n)}$ is

$$[4pM^{(n)}]_t = 16p^2 V_{t \wedge \tau_n} \leq 16p^2 n, \quad 0 \leq t \leq h.$$

Consider its stochastic exponential

$$\Lambda_t^{(2p,n)} = \exp\left(4pM_{t \wedge \tau_n} - 8p^2 V_{t \wedge \tau_n}\right).$$

Novikov's criterion applies because

$$\mathbb{E} \left[\exp \left(\frac{1}{2} [4pM^{(n)}]_h \right) \right] \leq e^{8p^2 n} < \infty.$$

Hence $\Lambda^{(2p,n)}$ is a true mean-one martingale, not merely a local martingale, and

$$\mathbb{E} \left[\Lambda_h^{(2p,n)} \right] = 1. \quad (43)$$

The definitions of D and $\Lambda^{(2p,n)}$ give the exact algebraic identity

$$D_{h \wedge \tau_n}^{2p} = [\Lambda_h^{(2p,n)}]^{1/2} e^{(4p^2-p)V_{h \wedge \tau_n}}.$$

Cauchy–Schwarz, (43), and $V_{h \wedge \tau_n} \leq V_h$ yield

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E} \left[D_{h \wedge \tau_n}^{2p} \right] &\leq \left\{ \mathbb{E} [\Lambda_h^{(2p,n)}] \right\}^{1/2} \left\{ \mathbb{E} \left[e^{(8p^2-2p)V_{h \wedge \tau_n}} \right] \right\}^{1/2} \\ &\leq \left\{ \mathbb{E} \left[e^{(8p^2-2p)V_h} \right] \right\}^{1/2}. \end{aligned}$$

Since $V_h \leq L^2 J_h / 2$, (33) gives

$$\mathbb{E} \left[D_{h \wedge \tau_n}^{2p} \right] \leq (1-u)^{-d/4}, \quad u = 4p(4p-1)L^2 h^2,$$

provided $u < 1$. By (40),

$$u \leq 16p^2 L^2 h^2 \leq 16c^2 \frac{p}{d+p} \leq 16c^2.$$

Choose the universal constant $c > 0$ in the statement so that $16c^2 \leq 1/2$. It follows that $0 \leq u \leq 1/2$, and hence

$$\log \left(\frac{1}{1-u} \right) \leq 2u.$$

Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} \log \|D_{h \wedge \tau_n}\|_{L^{2p}(\mathbb{P})} &= \frac{1}{2p} \log \left(\mathbb{E} \left[D_{h \wedge \tau_n}^{2p} \right] \right) \\ &\leq \frac{d}{8p} \log \left(\frac{1}{1-u} \right) \\ &\leq \frac{du}{4p} \\ &\leq 4dp L^2 h^2 \\ &\leq 4c^2 \frac{d}{d+p} \\ &\leq 4c^2. \end{aligned}$$

Thus

$$\|D_{h \wedge \tau_n}\|_{L^{2p}(\mathbb{P})} \leq e^{4c^2} \quad (44)$$

uniformly in n . Finally, $V_h < \infty$ almost surely. For every sample path, once $n > V_h$, one has $\tau_n = \infty$ and hence $D_{h \wedge \tau_n} = D_h$. Fatou's lemma applied to the $(2p)$ -th powers in (44) gives

$$\|D_h\|_{L^{2p}(\mathbb{P})} \leq e^{4c^2}. \quad (45)$$

This proves the first estimate in (41).

Step 2: representation of $D_h - 1$ as a stochastic integral. Let

$$Y_t = M_t - \frac{1}{2}V_t, \quad D_t = e^{Y_t}.$$

The process V has finite variation, so $[Y]_t = [M]_t = V_t$. Itô's formula for the function $y \mapsto e^y$ gives

$$dD_t = D_t dY_t + \frac{1}{2}D_t d[Y]_t$$

$$\begin{aligned}
&= D_t \left(dM_t - \frac{1}{2} dV_t \right) + \frac{1}{2} D_t dV_t \\
&= D_t dM_t \\
&= D_t \langle \theta_t, dB_t \rangle.
\end{aligned}$$

Integrating this identity from zero to t gives the local-martingale representation

$$D_t - 1 = \int_0^t D_s \langle \theta_s, dB_s \rangle. \quad (46)$$

See [Karatzas and Shreve \[1991, Chapter 3\]](#) or [Revuz and Yor \[1999, Chapter IV\]](#) for Itô's formula and the quadratic variation rules used here.

Step 3: application of BDG to an explicitly stopped martingale. For $n \geq 2$, define

$$\sigma_n = \tau_n \wedge \inf\{t \in [0, h] : D_t \geq n\}, \quad \inf \emptyset = \infty.$$

Both V_t and D_t are continuous and adapted, so σ_n is a stopping time. Stopping the process identity (46) and using (42) gives, for every deterministic $t \in [0, h]$,

$$\begin{aligned}
R_t^{(n)} &:= D_{t \wedge \sigma_n} - 1 \\
&= \int_0^{t \wedge \sigma_n} D_s \langle \theta_s, dB_s \rangle \\
&= \int_0^t \mathbf{1}_{\{s \leq \sigma_n\}} D_s \langle \theta_s, dB_s \rangle.
\end{aligned}$$

Thus $R^{(n)}$ is a square-integrable continuous martingale. Indeed, its quadratic variation is

$$[R^{(n)}]_h = \int_0^h \mathbf{1}_{\{s \leq \sigma_n\}} D_s^2 \|\theta_s\|^2 ds = \int_0^{h \wedge \sigma_n} D_s^2 \|\theta_s\|^2 ds \leq n^2 V_{h \wedge \tau_n} \leq n^3.$$

The possible distinction between $s < \sigma_n$ and $s \leq \sigma_n$ is immaterial for the Lebesgue and Itô integrals.

For $p \geq 2$, apply the quantitative BDG inequality to the stopped continuous martingale $R^{(n)}$ at the deterministic time h . In the explicit form of [Ren \[2008, Theorem 2\]](#),

$$\|R_h^{(n)}\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} \leq \left\| \sup_{0 \leq t \leq h} |R_t^{(n)}| \right\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} \leq 2\sqrt{2p} \| [R^{(n)}]_h^{1/2} \|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})}. \quad (47)$$

This is the point at which the assumption $p \geq 2$ is used.

Pathwise,

$$[R^{(n)}]_h^{1/2} \leq \left(\sup_{0 \leq s \leq h} D_s \right) V_h^{1/2}.$$

Hölder's inequality with exponents two and two therefore gives

$$\begin{aligned}
\| [R^{(n)}]_h^{1/2} \|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} &\leq \left\| \sup_{0 \leq s \leq h} D_s \right\|_{L^{2p}(\mathbb{P})} \| V_h^{1/2} \|_{L^{2p}(\mathbb{P})} \\
&= \left\| \sup_{0 \leq s \leq h} D_s \right\|_{L^{2p}(\mathbb{P})} \| V_h \|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})}^{1/2}.
\end{aligned} \quad (48)$$

By Lemma B.4, D_t is a nonnegative true martingale. Therefore Doob's maximal inequality [Revuz and Yor, 1999, Chapter II, Section 1] yields

$$\begin{aligned} \left\| \sup_{0 \leq s \leq h} D_s \right\|_{L^{2p}(\mathbb{P})} &\leq \frac{2p}{2p-1} \|D_h\|_{L^{2p}(\mathbb{P})} \\ &\leq C, \end{aligned}$$

where the last inequality follows from (45). Moreover, (35) gives

$$\|V_h\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})}^{1/2} \leq CLh\sqrt{d+p}.$$

Substituting these bounds into (47)–(48) gives, uniformly in n ,

$$\|D_{h \wedge \sigma_n} - 1\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} \leq CLh\sqrt{p(d+p)}. \quad (49)$$

To remove the stopping, note that the continuous functions $t \mapsto V_t$ and $t \mapsto D_t$ are bounded on the compact interval $[0, h]$ for every sample path. Hence $\sigma_n > h$ for all sufficiently large n , path by path, and

$$D_{h \wedge \sigma_n} - 1 \longrightarrow D_h - 1 \quad \text{almost surely.}$$

Fatou's lemma applied to (49) proves

$$\|D_h - 1\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} \leq CLh\sqrt{p(d+p)}.$$

This is the second estimate in (41) and completes the proof. $\square$

B.3 From path likelihood to MALA rejection

Proof of Proposition B.1. Choose the universal constant c in Proposition B.1 no larger than the constant c in Lemma B.5 and sufficiently small so that the step-size condition $h \leq c/(L\sqrt{p}(d+p))$ implies $Lh < 1$.

Let S_h be the exact Langevin transition kernel. Define two endpoint probability measures on $\mathbb{R}^d \times \mathbb{R}^d$:

$$\nu_h(dx, dy) = \pi(dx)S_h(x, dy), \quad \mu_h(dx, dy) = \pi(dx)Q_h(x, dy).$$

The measure ν_h is the law of (X_0, X_h) under the exact path law $\mathbb{P}$. By Lemma B.4, μ_h is the law of (X_0, X_h) under $\mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}$. Moreover, (36) gives

$$\frac{d\mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}}{d\mathbb{P}} = D_h \quad \text{on } \mathcal{F}_h,$$

so $\mu_h \ll \nu_h$. Let

$$F_h = \frac{d\mu_h}{d\nu_h}.$$

We next pass from the full-path likelihood D_h to the endpoint likelihood F_h . By the Doob–Dynkin lemma, $\mathbb{E}[D_h \mid \sigma(X_0, X_h)]$ has a Borel-measurable representation as a function of the two endpoints; this function is a version of F_h . Indeed, for every bounded Borel function $\varphi : \mathbb{R}^d \times \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$,

$$\begin{aligned} \int \varphi(x, y) \mu_h(dx, dy) &= \mathbb{E}_{\mathbb{P}_h^{\text{fr}}}[\varphi(X_0, X_h)] \\ &= \mathbb{E}[D_h \varphi(X_0, X_h)] \end{aligned}$$

$$= \mathbb{E} \{ \mathbb{E}[D_h \mid \sigma(X_0, X_h)] \varphi(X_0, X_h) \}.$$

This is exactly the defining Radon–Nikodym identity. Thus

$$F_h(X_0, X_h) = \mathbb{E}[D_h \mid \sigma(X_0, X_h)] \quad \mathbb{P}\text{-almost surely.} \quad (50)$$

This is the usual principle that the likelihood ratio of an observed statistic is the conditional expectation of the full-data likelihood ratio; see [Kallenberg \[2021\]](#) for conditional expectation, disintegration, and regular conditional distributions.

Subtracting one in (50) and using conditional Jensen’s inequality gives the L^p -contraction explicitly:

$$\begin{aligned} \|F_h - 1\|_{L^p(\nu_h)}^p &= \mathbb{E} |\mathbb{E}[D_h - 1 \mid \sigma(X_0, X_h)]|^p \\ &\leq \mathbb{E} \{ \mathbb{E} [|D_h - 1|^p \mid \sigma(X_0, X_h)] \} \\ &= \|D_h - 1\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})}^p. \end{aligned}$$

Hence

$$\|F_h - 1\|_{L^p(\nu_h)} \leq \|D_h - 1\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})}. \quad (51)$$

We also need the conditional form of $\mu_h = F_h \nu_h$. Evaluating this measure identity on a rectangle $A \times B$ gives

$$\int_A Q_h(x, B) \pi(dx) = \int_A \int_B F_h(x, y) S_h(x, dy) \pi(dx). \quad (52)$$

Fix a countable π -system $\mathcal{C}$ that generates the Borel σ -field on $\mathbb{R}^d$, for example, the finite intersections of open balls with rational centers and radii, together with $\mathbb{R}^d$. For each $B \in \mathcal{C}$, equality (52) for every Borel A implies equality of the two integrands for π -almost every x . Since $\mathcal{C}$ is countable, there is one π -null set outside which this holds simultaneously for every $B \in \mathcal{C}$. For each fixed x outside that null set, both sides are measures in B , and the monotone-class theorem extends their equality from $\mathcal{C}$ to all Borel sets. Thus, for π -almost every x ,

$$Q_h(x, dy) = F_h(x, y) S_h(x, dy). \quad (53)$$

Reversibility of exact Langevin makes ν_h symmetric. Hence the transpose proposal flow $\mu_h^\top(dx, dy) = \mu_h(dy, dx)$ has density $F_h(y, x)$ relative to ν_h . On the set where $F_h(x, y) > 0$, the Metropolis ratio is the Radon–Nikodym quotient $F_h(y, x)/F_h(x, y)$; on the complementary set the usual zero-density convention gives the same formula below. Therefore the density of the accepted proposal flow relative to ν_h is

$$F_h(x, y) \min \left\{ 1, \frac{F_h(y, x)}{F_h(x, y)} \right\} = \min \{ F_h(x, y), F_h(y, x) \}.$$

Equivalently, the accepted flow is the meet of the proposal flow and its transpose [[Tierney, 1998](#), [Billera and Diaconis, 2001](#)]:

$$\pi(dx) Q_h(x, dy) \alpha_h(x, y) = \min \{ F_h(x, y), F_h(y, x) \} \nu_h(dx, dy). \quad (54)$$

Disintegrate both sides of (54) with respect to the first coordinate, using the same countable-generator and monotone-class argument as in the proof of (53). Then (53) gives, for π -almost every x ,

$$r_h(x) = \int [F_h(x, y) - \min \{ F_h(x, y), F_h(y, x) \}] S_h(x, dy)$$

$$\leq \int (|F_h(x, y) - 1| + |F_h(y, x) - 1|) S_h(x, dy).$$

Define

$$A_h(x) = \int |F_h(x, y) - 1| S_h(x, dy), \quad B_h(x) = \int |F_h(y, x) - 1| S_h(x, dy).$$

Then $r_h \leq A_h + B_h$. Jensen's inequality for the probability measure $S_h(x, dy)$ gives

$$\begin{aligned} \|A_h\|_{L^p(\pi)}^p &\leq \int |F_h(x, y) - 1|^p \nu_h(dx, dy), \\ \|B_h\|_{L^p(\pi)}^p &\leq \int |F_h(y, x) - 1|^p \nu_h(dx, dy). \end{aligned}$$

The first right-hand side is $\|F_h - 1\|_{L^p(\nu_h)}^p$; the second is the same because ν_h is symmetric. Minkowski's inequality therefore yields

$$\|r_h\|_{L^p(\pi)} \leq \|A_h\|_{L^p(\pi)} + \|B_h\|_{L^p(\pi)} \leq 2 \|F_h - 1\|_{L^p(\nu_h)}. \quad (55)$$

Combining (55), (51), and Lemma B.5 gives

$$\|r_h\|_{L^p(\pi)} \leq 2 \|D_h - 1\|_{L^p(\mathbb{P})} \leq CLh\sqrt{p(d+p)},$$

after absorbing the factor two into the universal constant. This is (27). $\square$

B.4 Proving Proposition 3.2

Proof. Decrease c_r , if necessary, so that $c_r \leq 1$ and so that Proposition B.1 applies under (4). Fix $p \geq 2$ and t satisfying that condition. Since $d \geq 1$ and $p \geq 2$, it also implies $t < 2/L$. Define the rejection probability averaged over $[t/2, t]$ by

$$\bar{r}_t(x) = \frac{2}{t} \int_{t/2}^t r_h(x) dh.$$

After decreasing the universal step constant, Proposition B.1 applies to every $h \in [t/2, t]$. Minkowski's integral inequality gives

$$\begin{aligned} \|\bar{r}_t\|_{L^p(\pi)} &\leq \frac{2}{t} \int_{t/2}^t \|r_h\|_{L^p(\pi)} dh \\ &\leq \frac{3C}{4} Lt \sqrt{p(d+p)}. \end{aligned}$$

Set

$$G_{t,p} = \{x : \bar{r}_t(x) \leq 1/3\}.$$

Markov's inequality yields

$$\pi(G_{t,p}^c) \leq \left(\frac{9C}{4} Lt \sqrt{p(d+p)} \right)^p,$$

which is (5) after renaming the universal constant.

We next compare nearby proposal laws. The Baillon–Haddad cocoercivity inequality states that [Nesterov, 2004, Theorem 2.1.5]

$$\langle \nabla U(x) - \nabla U(y), x - y \rangle \geq \frac{1}{L} \|\nabla U(x) - \nabla U(y)\|^2.$$

See also [Bauschke and Combettes \[2010\]](#). Consequently, for $h \leq 2/L$,

$$\begin{aligned} & \|x - h\nabla U(x) - y + h\nabla U(y)\|^2 \\ &= \|x - y\|^2 - 2h \langle x - y, \nabla U(x) - \nabla U(y) \rangle + h^2 \|\nabla U(x) - \nabla U(y)\|^2 \\ &\leq \|x - y\|^2. \end{aligned}$$

Thus the proposal mean map is nonexpansive. Two Gaussian laws with covariance $2hI_d$ and means μ_x, μ_y have Kullback–Leibler divergence $\|\mu_x - \mu_y\|^2 / (4h)$. Pinsker’s inequality [[Tsybakov, 2009](#), Lemma 2.5] therefore gives

$$\text{TV}(Q_h(x, \cdot), Q_h(y, \cdot)) \leq \frac{\|x - y\|}{\sqrt{8h}} \leq \frac{\|x - y\|}{2\sqrt{t}}, \quad h \in [t/2, t]. \quad (56)$$

For fixed x , write

$$R_{h,x}(\text{d}y) = [1 - \alpha_h(x, y)] Q_h(x, \text{d}y).$$

This measure has total mass $r_h(x)$, and, because $Q_h(x, \cdot)$ has a Lebesgue density, it gives no mass to $\{x\}$. Hence

$$P_h(x, \cdot) - Q_h(x, \cdot) = r_h(x)\delta_x - R_{h,x}$$

is the Jordan decomposition into mutually singular positive and negative parts. With the convention $\text{TV}(\mu, \nu) = \sup_A |\mu(A) - \nu(A)|$, this proves

$$\text{TV}(P_h(x, \cdot), Q_h(x, \cdot)) = r_h(x). \quad (57)$$

Total variation is convex under mixing: for probability kernels M_h, N_h and a probability measure ρ ,

$$\text{TV}\left(\int M_h \text{d}\rho, \int N_h \text{d}\rho\right) \leq \int \text{TV}(M_h, N_h) \text{d}\rho.$$

Applying this fact three times, together with the triangle inequality, (57), and (56), gives, for $x, y \in G_{t,p}$ with $\|x - y\| \leq \sqrt{t}/16$,

$$\begin{aligned} \text{TV}(\mathcal{K}_t(x, \cdot), \mathcal{K}_t(y, \cdot)) &\leq \bar{r}_t(x) + \frac{2}{t} \int_{t/2}^t \text{TV}(Q_h(x, \cdot), Q_h(y, \cdot)) \text{d}h + \bar{r}_t(y) \\ &\leq \frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{32} + \frac{1}{3} = \frac{67}{96} < \frac{3}{4}. \end{aligned}$$

This proves the first assertion of [Proposition 3.2](#). We note that this type of argument is common in the MCMC literature; see, e.g., the proof of Theorem 3 in [Wu et al. \[2022\]](#).

It remains to prove the final assertion. Write $g_x = \nabla U(x)$, let $Y = x - hg_x + \sqrt{2h}Z$, and put $g_Y = \nabla U(Y)$. We first derive the log-ratio identity used below. Since

$$q_h(a, b) = (4\pi h)^{-d/2} \exp\left[-\frac{\|b - a + h\nabla U(a)\|^2}{4h}\right],$$

one has

$$\begin{aligned} \log \frac{e^{-U(Y)} q_h(Y, x)}{e^{-U(x)} q_h(x, Y)} &= U(x) - U(Y) \\ &\quad + \frac{1}{4h} \left(\|Y - x + hg_x\|^2 - \|x - Y + hg_Y\|^2 \right). \end{aligned}$$

Now $Y - x + hg_x = \sqrt{2h}Z$ and $x - Y = hg_x - \sqrt{2h}Z$. Expanding the two squared norms and collecting the gradient and Gaussian terms gives

$$\begin{aligned} \log \frac{e^{-U(Y)} q_h(Y, x)}{e^{-U(x)} q_h(x, Y)} &= U(x) - U(Y) - \langle g_Y, x - Y \rangle - \frac{h}{4} \|g_Y - g_x\|^2 \\ &\quad - \sqrt{\frac{h}{2}} \langle Z, g_Y - g_x \rangle. \end{aligned} \quad (58)$$

The Baillon–Haddad inequality [Nesterov, 2004, Theorem 2.1.5] gives

$$U(x) - U(Y) - \langle g_Y, x - Y \rangle \geq \frac{1}{2L} \|g_Y - g_x\|^2.$$

If $h \leq 1/L$, the right-hand side of (58) is therefore at least

$$\frac{1}{4L} \|g_Y - g_x\|^2 - \sqrt{\frac{h}{2}} \|Z\| \|g_Y - g_x\| \geq -\frac{Lh}{2} \|Z\|^2.$$

It follows that

$$\alpha_h(x, Y) \geq e^{-Lh\|Z\|^2/2}, \quad \mathbb{E}\alpha_h(x, Y) \geq (1 + Lh)^{-d/2} \geq e^{-Lhd/2}.$$

Let $t' \in (0, 1/(2Ld)]$. Then every $h \in [t'/2, t']$ has rejection probability at most $1 - e^{-1/4}$, uniformly in x . Combining two such rejection bounds with (56), we obtain, whenever $\|x - y\| \leq \sqrt{t'}/16$,

$$\text{TV}(\mathcal{K}_{t'}(x, \cdot), \mathcal{K}_{t'}(y, \cdot)) \leq 2(1 - e^{-1/4}) + \frac{1}{32} < \frac{3}{4}.$$

This proves the final assertion of Proposition 3.2 and completes the proof. $\square$

C Proof of Proposition 3.3

We repeatedly use the following notation for the standard Gaussian distribution:

$$\varphi(x) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} e^{-x^2/2}, \quad \Phi(x) = \int_{-\infty}^x \varphi(v) dv, \quad \bar{\Phi}(x) = 1 - \Phi(x).$$

C.1 Some basic properties of Gaussian distribution functions

Equation (6), due to Bakry and Ledoux [1996], states that

$$\pi(A^r) \geq \Phi(\Phi^{-1}(\pi(A)) + \sqrt{mr}).$$

We analyze the map $(q, s) \mapsto \Phi(\Phi^{-1}(q) + s)$.

We begin with a Mills-ratio bound.

Lemma C.1. *Let $a \geq 0$. Then*

$$\frac{\varphi(a)}{1+a} \leq \bar{\Phi}(a) \leq \frac{2\varphi(a)}{1+a}. \quad (59)$$

Moreover,

$$\log \frac{1}{\bar{\Phi}(a)} \leq (1+a)^2. \quad (60)$$

Proof. Let

$$g(a) = \bar{\Phi}(a) - \frac{\varphi(a)}{1+a}.$$

Then $g(a) \rightarrow 0$ as $a \rightarrow \infty$, and direct differentiation gives

$$g'(a) = -\frac{a\varphi(a)}{(1+a)^2} \leq 0.$$

Thus $g(a) \geq 0$, proving the lower bound in (59). Similarly, for

$$f(a) = \frac{2\varphi(a)}{1+a} - \bar{\Phi}(a),$$

we have $f(a) \rightarrow 0$ as $a \rightarrow \infty$ and

$$f'(a) = -\frac{(1+a^2)\varphi(a)}{(1+a)^2} < 0.$$

Hence $f(a) \geq 0$, proving the upper bound. Classical sharper Mills bounds for $a > 0$ go back at least to [Gordon \[1941\]](#).

The lower bound in (59) implies

$$\log \frac{1}{\bar{\Phi}(a)} \leq \frac{a^2}{2} + \log(1+a) + \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi).$$

The difference between $(1+a)^2$ and the right-hand side is positive at $a = 0$, and its derivative is

$$2+a - \frac{1}{1+a} > 0.$$

This proves (60). □

Lemma C.2. *Let $q \in (0, 1/2]$ and $s \geq 0$. Then*

$$\Phi(\Phi^{-1}(q) + s) - q \geq \frac{q}{4} \min \left\{ 1, s\sqrt{\log(1/q)} \right\}.$$

Proof. Write $\Phi^{-1}(q) = -a$, so $a \geq 0$ and $q = \bar{\Phi}(a)$. Then

$$\Phi(-a+s) - \Phi(-a) = \int_0^s \varphi(a-v) dv.$$

For $0 \leq v \leq \min\{s, 1\}$,

$$\frac{\varphi(a-v)}{\varphi(a)} = e^{av-v^2/2} \geq e^{-1/2}.$$

By the upper Mills bound in (59), $\varphi(a) \geq q(1+a)/2$. Hence

$$\begin{aligned} \Phi(-a+s) - \Phi(-a) &\geq \frac{e^{-1/2}}{2} q(1+a) \min\{s, 1\} \\ &\geq \frac{e^{-1/2}}{2} q \min\{1, s(1+a)\} \\ &\geq \frac{q}{4} \min \left\{ 1, s\sqrt{\log(1/q)} \right\}. \end{aligned}$$

The second line uses $(1+a) \min\{s, 1\} \geq \min\{1, s(1+a)\}$; the third uses (60) and $e^{-1/2}/2 > 1/4$. □

C.2 Proving Proposition 3.3

Proof. If $r = 0$, the right-hand side of (7) is zero, so the conclusion is immediate. Assume $r > 0$ and, without loss of generality, that $\pi(A) = q$. Since $\text{dist}(A, B) \geq r$, the open enlargement A^r is disjoint from B , and hence $A^r \subseteq A \cup C$. Combining (6) and Lemma C.2 gives

$$\begin{aligned}\pi(C) &\geq \pi(A^r) - \pi(A) \\ &\geq \Phi(\Phi^{-1}(q) + \sqrt{m}r) - q \\ &\geq \frac{q}{4} \min \left\{ 1, r\sqrt{m \log(1/q)} \right\}.\end{aligned}$$

This is exactly (7). □

D Proof of Proposition 3.4

D.1 A generic conductance bound

We begin with a generic one-step flow bound for kernels that satisfy a close-coupling condition under the Gaussian isoperimetric inequality in Proposition 3.3. Combining close coupling with an isoperimetric inequality to lower-bound one-step flows, and hence conductance, is a standard technique. Related defective- or truncated-conductance arguments appear in Dwivedi et al. [2019], Wu et al. [2022], Chen and Gatmiry [2023], Liu and Tong [2026].

Lemma D.1. *Let K be π -reversible, let $t > 0$, and let $G \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$ satisfy*

$$x, y \in G, \quad \|x - y\| \leq \frac{\sqrt{t}}{16} \implies \text{TV}(K(x, \cdot), K(y, \cdot)) \leq \frac{3}{4}.$$

Let S be a measurable set such that $0 < \pi(S) \leq 1/2$, and suppose that

$$\pi(G^c) \leq 2^{-13} \pi(S) \min \left\{ 1, \sqrt{mt \log(1/\pi(S))} \right\}. \quad (61)$$

Then

$$\mathcal{J}_K(S, S^c) \geq 2^{-13} \pi(S) \min \left\{ 1, \sqrt{mt \log(1/\pi(S))} \right\}. \quad (62)$$

Proof. Fix a measurable S with $0 < \pi(S) \leq 1/2$. Let $s = \pi(S)$ and

$$\beta = \min \left\{ 1, \sqrt{mt \log(1/s)} \right\}.$$

Suppose, for contradiction, that

$$\mathcal{J}_K(S, S^c) < 2^{-13} s \beta.$$

Define

$$\begin{aligned}S_1 &= \{x \in S \cap G : K(x, S^c) < 1/16\}, \\ S_2 &= \{y \in S^c \cap G : K(y, S) < 1/16\}.\end{aligned}$$

For $x \in S_1$ and $y \in S_2$,

$$\text{TV}(K(x, \cdot), K(y, \cdot)) \geq K(x, S) - K(y, S) > \frac{7}{8}.$$

The close-coupling condition therefore implies

$$\text{dist}(S_1, S_2) \geq \frac{\sqrt{t}}{16}. \quad (63)$$

Markov's inequality and reversibility give

$$\begin{aligned} \pi(S_1) &\geq s - \pi(S \cap G^c) - 16\mathcal{J}_K(S, S^c), \\ \pi(S_2) &\geq 1 - s - \pi(S^c \cap G^c) - 16\mathcal{J}_K(S, S^c). \end{aligned}$$

By (61) and the assumed strict upper bound on the flow,

$$\pi(S_1) > s - 17 \cdot 2^{-13} s \beta, \quad \pi(S_2) > 1 - s - 17 \cdot 2^{-13} s \beta.$$

Since $0 < \beta \leq 1$, $17 \cdot 2^{-13} < 1/2$, and $1 - s \geq s$, it follows that

$$\pi(S_1) \geq \frac{s}{2}, \quad \pi(S_2) \geq \frac{s}{2}. \quad (64)$$

Set $q' = \min\{\pi(S_1), \pi(S_2)\}$. Because $S_1 \subseteq S$,

$$\frac{s}{2} \leq q' \leq s \leq \frac{1}{2}.$$

Apply [Proposition 3.3](#) to S_1, S_2 , and their complement. Since $q' \leq s$, one has $\log(1/q') \geq \log(1/s)$. Using (63), (64), and $\min\{1, x/16\} \geq \min\{1, x\}/16$, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \pi((S_1 \cup S_2)^c) &\geq \frac{q'}{4} \min \left\{ 1, \frac{1}{16} \sqrt{mt \log(1/q')} \right\} \\ &\geq \frac{s}{8} \cdot \frac{1}{16} \min \left\{ 1, \sqrt{mt \log(1/s)} \right\} = \frac{s}{128} \beta. \end{aligned} \quad (65)$$

On the other hand, the parts removed from S and S^c are disjoint, so we have the sharper upper bound

$$\begin{aligned} \pi((S_1 \cup S_2)^c) &\leq \pi(G^c) + 32\mathcal{J}_K(S, S^c) \\ &< 33 \cdot 2^{-13} s \beta < \frac{s}{128} \beta, \end{aligned}$$

contradicting (65). Therefore the assumed strict upper bound on the flow is impossible, and (62) holds. $\square$

D.2 A technical lemma

The proof of [Proposition 3.4](#) via [Lemma D.1](#) requires one additional technical lemma.

Lemma D.2. *Let c_r, C_r be the constants in [Proposition 3.2](#). Fix a number $b_0 > 0$ satisfying*

$$b_0 \leq \min \left\{ \frac{1}{2}, c_r, \frac{1}{16C_r} \right\}. \quad (66)$$

Let $p \geq p_\star := A_0\{1 + \log(d+1) + \log \kappa\}$, $\theta \in (0, 1]$, and

$$t = \frac{\theta b_0}{L \sqrt{p(d+p)}},$$

where A_0 satisfies

$$A_0 \geq \max \left\{ 2, \frac{13 \log 2 + \frac{1}{2} \log(2/b_0) + 1}{\log 16 - \frac{1}{2}} \right\}. \quad (67)$$

Then, for every $u \in [\log 2, p/2]$,

$$\left(\frac{\theta}{16} \right)^p \leq 2^{-13} e^{-u} \sqrt{mtu}. \quad (68)$$

Moreover, $mtu \leq b_0/2 < 1$ throughout this range.

Proof. The last assertion follows directly from $m/L = 1/\kappa$:

$$mtu = \frac{\theta b_0 u}{\kappa \sqrt{p(d+p)}} \leq \frac{\theta b_0}{2\kappa} \sqrt{\frac{p}{d+p}} \leq \frac{b_0}{2}.$$

We focus on proving (68). Since $u \mapsto e^{-u} \sqrt{u}$ decreases on $[1/2, \infty)$, the right-hand side of (68) is smallest at $u = p/2$. At that endpoint it equals

$$2^{-13} e^{-p/2} \left(\frac{\theta b_0}{2\kappa} \right)^{1/2} \left(\frac{p}{d+p} \right)^{1/4}.$$

Dividing the desired inequality at $u = p/2$ by $\theta^{1/2}$ shows that its left-hand side contains the factor $\theta^{p-1/2}$. Since $p \geq 2$ and $0 < \theta \leq 1$, this factor is at most one. It is therefore sufficient that

$$p \left(\log 16 - \frac{1}{2} \right) \geq 13 \log 2 + \frac{1}{2} \log \frac{2\kappa}{b_0} + \frac{1}{4} \log \frac{d+p}{p}. \quad (69)$$

Since $p \geq 1$,

$$\log \frac{d+p}{p} \leq \log(d+1).$$

The right-hand side of (69) is therefore at most

$$13 \log 2 + \frac{1}{2} \log \frac{2}{b_0} + \frac{1}{2} \log \kappa + \frac{1}{4} \log(d+1).$$

Thus any A_0 satisfying (67) is sufficient. Indeed, this choice gives

$$A_0 \left(\log 16 - \frac{1}{2} \right) \geq 13 \log 2 + \frac{1}{2} \log(2/b_0) \quad \text{and} \quad A_0 \left(\log 16 - \frac{1}{2} \right) \geq 1 > \frac{1}{2}.$$

Since $p \geq p_\star = A_0 \{1 + \log(d+1) + \log \kappa\}$, multiplying these coefficient-wise bounds by 1, $\log(d+1)$, and $\log \kappa$ proves (69), uniformly in all parameters. $\square$

D.3 Proving Proposition 3.4

Proof. We begin with the first assertion. Let A_0 and b_0 be universal constants satisfying (66) and (67). Let $p \geq p_\star := A_0 \{1 + \log(d+1) + \log \kappa\}$, $\theta \in (0, 1]$, and

$$t = \frac{\theta b_0}{L \sqrt{p(d+p)}}.$$

Let $S \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$ be measurable with $e^{-p/2} \leq \pi(S) \leq 1/2$. By Lemma D.2, since $\log(1/\pi(S)) \in [\log 2, p/2]$,

$$\left(\frac{\theta}{16} \right)^p \leq 2^{-13} \pi(S) \sqrt{mt \log(1/\pi(S))} = 2^{-13} \pi(S) \min \left\{ 1, \sqrt{mt \log(1/\pi(S))} \right\}.$$

Because $b_0 \leq c_r$ and $b_0 \leq 1/(16C_r)$, the first assertion of [Proposition 3.2](#) yields a measurable set $G_{t,p} \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$ such that

$$\pi(G_{t,p}^c) \leq \left[C_r L \frac{\theta b_0}{L \sqrt{p(d+p)}} \sqrt{p(d+p)} \right]^p \leq \left(\frac{\theta}{16} \right)^p,$$

and

$$x, y \in G_{t,p}, \quad \|x - y\| \leq \frac{\sqrt{t}}{16} \implies \text{TV}(\mathcal{K}_t(x, \cdot), \mathcal{K}_t(y, \cdot)) \leq \frac{3}{4}.$$

Then, by [Lemma D.1](#),

$$\mathcal{J}_{\mathcal{K}_t}(S, S^c) \geq 2^{-13} \pi(S) \min \left\{ 1, \sqrt{mt \log(1/\pi(S))} \right\} = 2^{-13} \pi(S) \sqrt{mt \log(1/\pi(S))}.$$

The equality follows from the final assertion of [Lemma D.2](#), namely, $mt \log(1/\pi(S)) \leq 1$. This proves the first assertion.

For the second assertion, let $t' \in (0, 1/(2Ld)]$ and let $S \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$ be measurable with $0 < \pi(S) \leq 1/2$. By the second assertion of [Proposition 3.2](#),

$$x, y \in \mathbb{R}^d, \quad \|x - y\| \leq \frac{\sqrt{t'}}{16} \implies \text{TV}(\mathcal{K}_{t'}(x, \cdot), \mathcal{K}_{t'}(y, \cdot)) \leq \frac{3}{4}.$$

Applying [Lemma D.1](#) with $G = \mathbb{R}^d$ yields

$$\mathcal{J}_{\mathcal{K}_{t'}}(S, S^c) \geq 2^{-13} \pi(S) \min \left\{ 1, \sqrt{mt' \log(1/\pi(S))} \right\}.$$

This proves the second assertion. □

E Proof of Lemma 3.5

The result can also be derived from the general Cheeger inequality of [Chen and Wang \[2000\]](#). The proof below is direct and self-contained; we include the details because the precise dependence on β_j and γ_j is needed later.

Proof. For $j = 1, \dots, N$, define the symmetric measure

$$\mathbf{J}_j(dx, dy) = \varpi(dx) K_j(x, dy).$$

The measure $\mathbf{J}_j$ is symmetric because K_j is ϖ -reversible. Both of its marginals equal ϖ .

We first prove the result for a nonnegative function $g \in L^2(\varpi)$ such that $\varpi(g > 0) \leq 1/2$. If $\sum_{j=1}^N \gamma_j \mathcal{E}_{K_j}(g, g) = \infty$, the desired inequality is immediate, so assume this sum is finite. For $t \geq 0$, let

$$A_t = \{x : g(x)^2 > t\}.$$

Then $\varpi(A_t) \leq 1/2$, so the assumed fractional boundary inequality gives

$$\varpi(A_t) \leq \sum_{j=1}^N \beta_j \mathcal{J}_{K_j}(A_t, A_t^c).$$

Integrating this inequality over $t \geq 0$ and using the layer-cake identity yields

$$\begin{aligned}\|g\|_{L^2(\varpi)}^2 &= \int_0^\infty \varpi(A_t) dt \\ &\leq \sum_{j=1}^N \beta_j \int_0^\infty \mathcal{J}_{K_j}(A_t, A_t^c) dt.\end{aligned}$$

For each j , symmetry of J_j gives the coarea identity

$$\int_0^\infty \mathcal{J}_{K_j}(A_t, A_t^c) dt = \frac{1}{2} \iint |g(x)^2 - g(y)^2| J_j(dx, dy).$$

Indeed, for fixed x, y ,

$$\int_0^\infty \mathbf{1}_{\{g(x)^2 > t \geq g(y)^2\}} dt = [g(x)^2 - g(y)^2]_+,$$

and symmetry changes the integral of the positive part into one half of the integral of the absolute difference. Consequently,

$$\|g\|_{L^2(\varpi)}^2 \leq \frac{1}{2} \sum_{j=1}^N \beta_j \iint |g(x) - g(y)| |g(x) + g(y)| J_j(dx, dy).$$

Apply Cauchy–Schwarz simultaneously over the component index j and the pair (x, y) :

$$\begin{aligned}\|g\|_{L^2(\varpi)}^2 &\leq \frac{1}{2} \left\{ \sum_{j=1}^N \gamma_j \iint [g(x) - g(y)]^2 J_j(dx, dy) \right\}^{1/2} \\ &\quad \times \left\{ \sum_{j=1}^N \frac{\beta_j^2}{\gamma_j} \iint [g(x) + g(y)]^2 J_j(dx, dy) \right\}^{1/2}.\end{aligned}$$

The first square root equals

$$\left[2 \sum_{j=1}^N \gamma_j \mathcal{E}_{K_j}(g, g) \right]^{1/2}.$$

For the second square root, the inequality

$$[g(x) + g(y)]^2 \leq 2g(x)^2 + 2g(y)^2$$

and the fact that both marginals of J_j equal ϖ give

$$\iint [g(x) + g(y)]^2 J_j(dx, dy) \leq 4 \|g\|_{L^2(\varpi)}^2.$$

It follows that

$$\|g\|_{L^2(\varpi)}^2 \leq \left[2 \sum_{j=1}^N \gamma_j \mathcal{E}_{K_j}(g, g) \right]^{1/2} \|g\|_{L^2(\varpi)} \left[\sum_{j=1}^N \frac{\beta_j^2}{\gamma_j} \right]^{1/2}.$$

If $g = 0$ in $L^2(\varpi)$, there is nothing to prove. Otherwise, cancelling one factor of $\|g\|_{L^2(\varpi)}$ and squaring gives

$$\sum_{j=1}^N \gamma_j \mathcal{E}_{K_j}(g, g) \geq \frac{\|g\|_{L^2(\varpi)}^2}{2 \sum_{j=1}^N \beta_j^2 / \gamma_j}. \quad (70)$$

Now let $f \in L^2(\varpi)$, and let c be a median of f ; thus

$$\varpi(f \geq c) \geq \frac{1}{2}, \quad \varpi(f \leq c) \geq \frac{1}{2}.$$

Define the positive and negative parts of $f - c$:

$$g_+ = (f - c)_+, \quad g_- = (f - c)_-.$$

Then

$$\varpi(g_+ > 0) \leq \frac{1}{2}, \quad \varpi(g_- > 0) \leq \frac{1}{2}.$$

Moreover, for every x, y ,

$$\begin{aligned} [f(x) - f(y)]^2 &\geq [g_+(x) - g_+(y)]^2 \\ &\quad + [g_-(x) - g_-(y)]^2. \end{aligned}$$

To see this, write

$$f - c = g_+ - g_-.$$

The two differences

$$g_+(x) - g_+(y) \quad \text{and} \quad g_-(x) - g_-(y)$$

have opposite signs, so the cross term in the square of their difference is nonnegative.

Therefore, by (70),

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{E}_P(f, f) &\geq \sum_{j=1}^N \gamma_j \mathcal{E}_{K_j}(f, f) \\ &\geq \sum_{j=1}^N \gamma_j \mathcal{E}_{K_j}(g_+, g_+) + \sum_{j=1}^N \gamma_j \mathcal{E}_{K_j}(g_-, g_-) \\ &\geq \frac{\|g_+\|_{L^2(\varpi)}^2 + \|g_-\|_{L^2(\varpi)}^2}{2 \sum_{j=1}^N \beta_j^2 / \gamma_j}. \end{aligned}$$

Since g_+ and g_- have disjoint supports and $f - c = g_+ - g_-$,

$$\|g_+\|_{L^2(\varpi)}^2 + \|g_-\|_{L^2(\varpi)}^2 = \|f - c\|_{L^2(\varpi)}^2.$$

The mean minimizes $a \mapsto \|f - a\|_{L^2(\varpi)}^2$, so

$$\|f - c\|_{L^2(\varpi)}^2 \geq \text{Var}_\varpi(f).$$

We conclude that

$$\mathcal{E}_P(f, f) \geq \frac{\text{Var}_\varpi(f)}{2 \sum_{j=1}^N \beta_j^2 / \gamma_j}.$$

Taking the infimum over all nonconstant $f \in L^2(\varpi)$ proves the claim. $\square$

F Multiscale arithmetic

This appendix verifies the summation estimate used in [Section 4](#). The constants b_0 and A_0 are the universal choices made at the beginning of the proof of [Theorem 2.1](#) in [Section 4](#).

Lemma F.1. *Assume $p_\star < d$, and define p_j, J, t_j, θ by (8)–(10). With*

$$\gamma_j = \frac{t_j}{2H}, \quad \phi_0^2 = 2^{-26} m t_0 \log 2, \quad \phi_j^2 = 2^{-29} m t_j p_j \quad (j \geq 1),$$

there is a universal $C > 0$ such that

$$\sum_{j=0}^J \frac{1}{\gamma_j \phi_j^2} \leq C \frac{H L^2 p_\star (d + p_\star)}{m \theta^2 b_0^2}.$$

Proof. For the first component,

$$\frac{1}{\gamma_0 \phi_0^2} = \frac{2^{27} H}{m t_0^2 \log 2} = \frac{2^{27} H L^2 p_\star (d + p_\star)}{m \theta^2 b_0^2 \log 2}.$$

For $j \geq 1$,

$$\frac{1}{\gamma_j \phi_j^2} = \frac{2^{30} H}{m t_j^2 p_j} = \frac{2^{30} H L^2 (d + p_j)}{m \theta^2 b_0^2}.$$

It remains to bound the sum of $d + p_j$. Because $p_\star < d$, one has $J \geq 1$. Minimality of J gives $4^{J-1} p_\star < d$, and hence

$$J < 1 + \log_4 \frac{d}{p_\star} \leq 1 + \log_4 d.$$

The geometric-series formula and (9) give

$$\sum_{j=1}^J p_j = p_\star \sum_{j=1}^J 4^j = \frac{4p_J - 4p_\star}{3} < \frac{16d}{3}.$$

Moreover, because $p_\star \geq A_0[1 + \log(d + 1)]$, it holds that

$$1 + \log_4 d \leq 1 + \frac{p_\star}{A_0 \log 4} \leq C p_\star,$$

where C is universal because $A_0 \geq 2$ and $p_\star \geq 2$. Therefore

$$\sum_{j=1}^J (d + p_j) = Jd + \sum_{j=1}^J p_j \leq C p_\star d.$$

Adding the first-component term and using $p_\star \geq 1$ yields

$$p_\star (d + p_\star) + \sum_{j=1}^J (d + p_j) \leq C p_\star (d + p_\star),$$

which proves the claimed estimate. □

References

- Christophe Andrieu, Anthony Lee, Sam Power, and Andi Q. Wang. Explicit convergence bounds for metropolis markov chains: Isoperimetry, spectral gaps and profiles. *The Annals of Applied Probability*, 34(4):4022–4071, 2024. doi:[10.1214/24-AAP2058](https://doi.org/10.1214/24-AAP2058).
- Simon Apers, Sander Gribling, and Dániel Szilágyi. Hamiltonian monte carlo for efficient gaussian sampling: Long and random steps. *Journal of Machine Learning Research*, 25(348):1–30, 2024. URL <https://jmlr.org/papers/v25/23-1521.html>.
- Dominique Bakry and Michel Ledoux. Lévy–Gromov’s isoperimetric inequality for an infinite-dimensional diffusion generator. *Inventiones Mathematicae*, 123(2):259–281, 1996. doi:[10.1007/BF01232376](https://doi.org/10.1007/BF01232376).
- Dominique Bakry, Ivan Gentil, and Michel Ledoux. *Analysis and Geometry of Markov Diffusion Operators*, volume 348 of *Grundlehren der mathematischen Wissenschaften*. Springer, 2014. doi:[10.1007/978-3-319-00227-9](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-00227-9).
- Heinz H. Bauschke and Patrick L. Combettes. The Baillon–Haddad theorem revisited. *Journal of Convex Analysis*, 17(3–4):781–787, 2010. URL <https://www.heldermann.de/JCA/JCA17/JCA173/jca17051.htm>.
- Louis J. Billera and Persi Diaconis. A geometric interpretation of the metropolis–hastings algorithm. *Statistical Science*, 16(4):335–339, 2001. doi:[10.1214/ss/1015346318](https://doi.org/10.1214/ss/1015346318).
- Nawaf Bou-Rabee and Martin Hairer. Non-asymptotic mixing of the MALA algorithm. *IMA Journal of Numerical Analysis*, 33(1):80–110, 2013. doi:[10.1093/imanum/drs003](https://doi.org/10.1093/imanum/drs003).
- Nawaf Bou-Rabee and Jesús María Sanz-Serna. Randomized hamiltonian monte carlo. *The Annals of Applied Probability*, 27(4):2159–2194, 2017. doi:[10.1214/16-AAP1255](https://doi.org/10.1214/16-AAP1255).
- Nawaf Bou-Rabee and Eric Vanden-Eijnden. Pathwise accuracy and ergodicity of metropolized integrators for SDEs. *Communications on Pure and Applied Mathematics*, 63(5):655–696, 2010. doi:[10.1002/cpa.20306](https://doi.org/10.1002/cpa.20306).
- Stéphane Boucheron, Gábor Lugosi, and Pascal Massart. *Concentration Inequalities: A Nonasymptotic Theory of Independence*. Oxford University Press, 2013. doi:[10.1093/acprof:oso/9780199535255.001.0001](https://doi.org/10.1093/acprof:oso/9780199535255.001.0001).
- Mu-Fa Chen and Feng-Yu Wang. Cheeger’s inequalities for general symmetric forms and existence criteria for spectral gap. *The Annals of Probability*, 28(1):235–257, 2000. doi:[10.1214/aop/1019160118](https://doi.org/10.1214/aop/1019160118).
- Yuansi Chen and Khashayar Gatmiry. A simple proof of the mixing of metropolis-adjusted Langevin algorithm under smoothness and isoperimetry, 2023. Version 2.
- Sinho Chewi, Chen Lu, Kwangjun Ahn, Xiang Cheng, Thibaut Le Gouic, and Philippe Rigollet. Optimal dimension dependence of the metropolis-adjusted Langevin algorithm. In *Proceedings of the Thirty-Fourth Conference on Learning Theory*, volume 134 of *Proceedings of Machine Learning Research*, pages 1260–1300. PMLR, 2021. URL <https://proceedings.mlr.press/v134/chewi21a.html>.
- E. B. Davies. *Heat Kernels and Spectral Theory*, volume 92 of *Cambridge Tracts in Mathematics*. Cambridge University Press, 1989. doi:[10.1017/CBO9780511566158](https://doi.org/10.1017/CBO9780511566158).

- Raaz Dwivedi, Yuansi Chen, Martin J. Wainwright, and Bin Yu. Log-concave sampling: Metropolis–Hastings algorithms are fast. *Journal of Machine Learning Research*, 20(183):1–42, 2019. URL <https://jmlr.org/papers/v20/19-306.html>.
- Masatoshi Fukushima, Yoichi Oshima, and Masayoshi Takeda. *Dirichlet Forms and Symmetric Markov Processes*, volume 19 of *De Gruyter Studies in Mathematics*. De Gruyter, 2 edition, 2011. doi:[10.1515/9783110218091](https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110218091).
- Sharad Goel, Ravi Montenegro, and Prasad Tetali. Mixing time bounds via the spectral profile. *Electronic Journal of Probability*, 11:1–26, 2006. doi:[10.1214/EJP.v11-302](https://doi.org/10.1214/EJP.v11-302).
- Robert D. Gordon. Values of Mills’ ratio of area to bounding ordinate and of the normal probability integral for large values of the argument. *The Annals of Mathematical Statistics*, 12(3):364–366, 1941. doi:[10.1214/aoms/1177731721](https://doi.org/10.1214/aoms/1177731721).
- Sebastiano Grazi, Samuel Livingstone, and Lionel Riou-Durand. On randomized step sizes in metropolis–hastings algorithms. *Japanese Journal of Statistics and Data Science*, 2026. doi:[10.1007/s42081-026-00369-7](https://doi.org/10.1007/s42081-026-00369-7). Published online 1 August 2026.
- Daniel Hsu, Sham M. Kakade, and Tong Zhang. A tail inequality for quadratic forms of subgaussian random vectors. *Electronic Communications in Probability*, 17(52):1–6, 2012. doi:[10.1214/ECP.v17-2079](https://doi.org/10.1214/ECP.v17-2079).
- Olav Kallenberg. *Foundations of Modern Probability*. Probability Theory and Stochastic Modelling. Springer, 3 edition, 2021. doi:[10.1007/978-3-030-61871-1](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-61871-1).
- Ravi Kannan, László Lovász, and Ravi Montenegro. Blocking conductance and mixing in random walks. *Combinatorics, Probability and Computing*, 15(4):541–570, 2006. doi:[10.1017/S0963548306007393](https://doi.org/10.1017/S0963548306007393).
- Ioannis Karatzas and Steven E. Shreve. *Brownian Motion and Stochastic Calculus*, volume 113 of *Graduate Texts in Mathematics*. Springer, 2 edition, 1991. doi:[10.1007/978-1-4612-0949-2](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-1-4612-0949-2).
- Norihiko Kazamaki. *Continuous Exponential Martingales and BMO*, volume 1579 of *Lecture Notes in Mathematics*. Springer, 1994. doi:[10.1007/BFb0073585](https://doi.org/10.1007/BFb0073585).
- Claude Kipnis and S. R. S. Varadhan. Central limit theorem for additive functionals of reversible markov processes and applications to simple exclusions. *Communications in Mathematical Physics*, 104(1):1–19, 1986. doi:[10.1007/BF01210789](https://doi.org/10.1007/BF01210789).
- Ioannis Kontoyiannis and Sean P. Meyn. Geometric ergodicity and the spectral gap of non-reversible markov chains. *Probability Theory and Related Fields*, 154(1–2):327–339, 2012. doi:[10.1007/s00440-011-0373-4](https://doi.org/10.1007/s00440-011-0373-4).
- Kazuhiro Kuwae and Toshihiro Uemura. Weak convergence of symmetric diffusion processes. *Probability Theory and Related Fields*, 109(2):159–182, 1997. doi:[10.1007/s004400050129](https://doi.org/10.1007/s004400050129).
- Gregory F. Lawler and Alan D. Sokal. Bounds on the L^2 spectrum for Markov chains and Markov processes: A generalization of Cheeger’s inequality. *Transactions of the American Mathematical Society*, 309(2):557–580, 1988. doi:[10.1090/S0002-9947-1988-0930082-9](https://doi.org/10.1090/S0002-9947-1988-0930082-9).
- Shuigen Liu and Xin T. Tong. Spectral gap of metropolis algorithms for non-smooth distributions under isoperimetry. *Japanese Journal of Statistics and Data Science*, 2026. doi:[10.1007/s42081-026-00354-0](https://doi.org/10.1007/s42081-026-00354-0). URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/s42081-026-00354-0>. Online first.

- László Lovász and Ravi Kannan. Faster mixing via average conductance. In *Proceedings of the Thirty-First Annual ACM Symposium on Theory of Computing*, pages 282–287. ACM, 1999. doi:[10.1145/301250.301317](https://doi.org/10.1145/301250.301317).
- László Lovász and Miklós Simonovits. Random walks in a convex body and an improved volume algorithm. *Random Structures & Algorithms*, 4(4):359–412, 1993. doi:[10.1002/rsa.3240040402](https://doi.org/10.1002/rsa.3240040402).
- Terry J. Lyons and Wei An Zheng. A crossing estimate for the canonical process on a Dirichlet space and a tightness result. *Astérisque*, 157–158:249–271, 1988. URL https://www.numdam.org/item/AST_1988__157-158__249_0/.
- Ben Morris and Yuval Peres. Evolving sets, mixing and heat kernel bounds. *Probability Theory and Related Fields*, 133(2):245–266, 2005. doi:[10.1007/s00440-005-0437-1](https://doi.org/10.1007/s00440-005-0437-1).
- Radford M. Neal. MCMC using hamiltonian dynamics. In Steve Brooks, Andrew Gelman, Galin L. Jones, and Xiao-Li Meng, editors, *Handbook of Markov Chain Monte Carlo*, pages 113–162. Chapman and Hall/CRC, 2011. doi:[10.1201/b10905-6](https://doi.org/10.1201/b10905-6).
- Yurii Nesterov. *Introductory Lectures on Convex Optimization: A Basic Course*, volume 87 of *Applied Optimization*. Kluwer Academic Publishers, Boston, 2004. doi:[10.1007/978-1-4419-8853-9](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-1-4419-8853-9).
- El-Maati Ouhabaz. *Analysis of Heat Equations on Domains*, volume 31 of *London Mathematical Society Monographs Series*. Princeton University Press, 2005. doi:[10.1515/9781400826483](https://doi.org/10.1515/9781400826483).
- Daniel Paulin. Concentration inequalities for markov chains by Marton couplings and spectral methods. *Electronic Journal of Probability*, 20(79), 2015. doi:[10.1214/EJP.v20-4039](https://doi.org/10.1214/EJP.v20-4039).
- Philip E. Protter. *Stochastic Integration and Differential Equations*, volume 21 of *Stochastic Modelling and Applied Probability*. Springer, 2 edition, 2005. doi:[10.1007/978-3-662-10061-5](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-662-10061-5).
- Qian Qin. Simulation and Lean package for "A global spectral gap for Metropolis-adjusted Langevin algorithm with a uniformly randomized step size". GitHub repository, <https://github.com/qianqin11/spectral-gap-randomized-step-MALA>, 2026.
- Yong-Feng Ren. On the burkholder–davis–gundy inequalities for continuous martingales. *Statistics & Probability Letters*, 78(17):3034–3039, 2008. doi:[10.1016/j.spl.2008.05.024](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.spl.2008.05.024).
- Daniel Revuz and Marc Yor. *Continuous Martingales and Brownian Motion*, volume 293 of *Grundlehren der mathematischen Wissenschaften*. Springer, 3 edition, 1999. doi:[10.1007/978-3-662-06400-9](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-662-06400-9).
- Gareth O. Roberts and Jeffrey S. Rosenthal. Geometric ergodicity and hybrid markov chains. *Electronic Communications in Probability*, 2:13–25, 1997. doi:[10.1214/ECP.v2-981](https://doi.org/10.1214/ECP.v2-981). URL <https://doi.org/10.1214/ECP.v2-981>.
- Gareth O. Roberts and Jeffrey S. Rosenthal. Optimal scaling of discrete approximations to Langevin diffusions. *Journal of the Royal Statistical Society: Series B*, 60(1):255–268, 1998. doi:[10.1111/1467-9868.00123](https://doi.org/10.1111/1467-9868.00123).
- Gareth O. Roberts and Richard L. Tweedie. Exponential convergence of Langevin distributions and their discrete approximations. *Bernoulli*, 2(4):341–363, 1996. doi:[10.2307/3318418](https://doi.org/10.2307/3318418).
- Daniel Rudolf. Explicit error bounds for markov chain monte carlo. *Dissertationes Mathematicae*, 485:1–93, 2012. doi:[10.4064/dm485-0-1](https://doi.org/10.4064/dm485-0-1).

- Luke Tierney. A note on metropolis–hastings kernels for general state spaces. *The Annals of Applied Probability*, 8(1):1–9, 1998. doi:[10.1214/aoap/1027961031](https://doi.org/10.1214/aoap/1027961031).
- Alexandre B. Tsybakov. *Introduction to Nonparametric Estimation*. Springer Series in Statistics. Springer, 2009. doi:[10.1007/b13794](https://doi.org/10.1007/b13794).
- Roman Vershynin. *High-Dimensional Probability: An Introduction with Applications in Data Science*, volume 47 of *Cambridge Series in Statistical and Probabilistic Mathematics*. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, 2018. doi:[10.1017/9781108231596](https://doi.org/10.1017/9781108231596).
- Keru Wu, Scott Schmidler, and Yuansi Chen. Minimax mixing time of the metropolis-adjusted Langevin algorithm for log-concave sampling. *Journal of Machine Learning Research*, 23(270): 1–63, 2022. URL <https://jmlr.org/papers/v23/21-1184.html>.